

An Essay on the Antient and Modern State of Ireland

Henry Brooke

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THE ANTIENT AND MODERN STATE OF IRELAND ***

An Essay On The

Ancient and Modern State Of Ireland

With the Various Important Advantages

Thereunto Derived,

under the auspicious Reign of His most sacred Majesty

King GEORGE the Second.

Including a particular Account

of the great and glorious

St. Patrick

By

Henry Brooke

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Dedication.

TO

MATTHEW M^C. NAMARA,

Of *LIMERICK*, Esq;

COUNSELLOR at LAW.

Justly sensible, Sir, how sincerely You have the Character and Esteem of our Native Country at Heart, I take Leave to offer to Your Perusal, and commend to Your favourable Acceptance, the following Sheets.

What gave them Rise, was my happening, some Time since, to have fallen into Company with two or three sprightly young Gentlemen, then just returned from their Continental Rambles,—who—altho' little burthened with the Religion, Laws, Learning, Policy, Customs, Habits, Manners, or Languages of any, or the several Countries they had scampered thro', affected, nevertheless, an high Contempt for this,—their Native.

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I listened with silent Indignation, and determined to contribute my Mite towards giving such unattentive, uninformed Youths, a more adequate Idea of this Kingdom, under its ancient and under its present happy Establishment.

The common Accidents of Time must lead them by better Authority to clearer Knowledge: In the mean while, I profess my Obligations to them, as they have given me this Opportunity of declaring my Regard to my Country in general, and the particular Attachments that ever bind me, in the strictest Sense of Fidelity and Esteem, to a Friend so worthy as You have been to,

Sir,

Your very obliged, and
Most obedient Servant.

[pg 005]

Essay.

In a Nation, where almost every Gentleman is better acquainted, and more conversant, with the Nature and Circumstances of other Countries than those of his own, the Publication of such Hints as may somewhat contribute to remove so odd an Inattention, and induce those far better qualified to render a Subject so interesting some Justice, will not, I hope, be deemed an Impertinence; in one especially who, by this Essay, however feeble, hath nothing beside the Honour and Advantage of [pg 006] *Ireland* in View, a Kingdom whereof he is, without Vanity, proud of being a Native.

As the Story of Savages and Barbarians can contain nothing instructive, or entertaining, the *Antemilesian* Inhabitants of this Land having been mostly such, and all surviving Accounts of them almost totally overcast with Fable, we are therefore, in treating of the antient *Scotia*, or modern *Ireland*, to refer principally to three distinguished æras, whereof the *first* is, its being peopled by an *Iberian* or *Spanish* Colony: The *second*, truly glorious, the Arrival of St. *Patrick*, in his most salutary Mission: The *third* and last, its Cession to *Henry* the Second, King of *England*, (the first of the Royal Race of *Plantagenet*) partly from a pretended Title of *Adrian* the Fourth, Pope of *Rome*; partly from the restless and insatiable Desires of *Henry*; *more* from the manifold Infirmities of the then reigning *Irish* Chiefs—but above all, from the peculiarly adverse Fate of *Roderick*, the last of our Kings.

The assiduous, exact, and candid Author of the *Dissertations*,^{[1](#)} lately published, on the Origin, Government, Letters, Sciences, Religion, Manners and Customs of the antient Inhabitants of this Country, hath put all those Matters in so clear and happy, and, at the same Time, in so strong a Light, by the Powers of various foreign Testimonies, of undeniable Authenticity, coincident with our own, that scarce any Thing new can be offered on the same Subject.

It may, however, in general be observed, that *Milesius*, a *Spanish* Prince, so far back as the Reign of *Solomon* (instigated by Necessity, or induced by Ambition) with a considerable [pg 007] Number of Associates and

Followers, landed from the Western Parts of *Spain*, on the Southern Coasts of this Island, where it is probable they met little, or but faint Opposition, from wild and undisciplined Inhabitants.

Those People, from their early Knowledge of the *Phœnician* Arts and Letters, imported such Rudiments of Government and Learning, as those primitive Times admitted; a Truth visible from the Similarity or rather Identity of the *Phœnician* and *Scotic* Alphabet.

This antient Colony quietly settled here, remote from the Storms and Revolutions of the greater World, and secured by Situation from its hostile Incursions, there is no Doubt but the Cultivation of Religion, Philosophy, Politicks, Poetry, and Musick, became the chief Objects of popular Study and Application: The Spirit of Ambition in succeeding Ages, with its unhappy concomitant Train of Sedition, Faction, and Violence, the foreign Invasions, and often the intestine Oppressions and Calamities, to which our neighbouring Nations were subject, calling forth the protective or conciliating Aids of those ancient Heroes, made them great Masters also in the Art military.

The Pentarchy originally formed by those *Iberian* or *Celtic Spaniards*, with a popular Right of Election, was certainly a Kind of Government extremely consistent with the Essence and Genius of true Liberty, and a System derived from the Patriarchs themselves. For when the various Necessities of Society required a Subordination, together with some stated Maxims to go by, to avoid the confused and promiscuous Intercourse in a State of Nature; then did the People elect the most Virtuous and Wise, to lead [pg 008] and conduct them in Times of War and Trouble; to govern, inform, and protect them, in milder and more auspicious Seasons. Then was the Motto of the Crown, or of the chief Ensign of Pre-eminence, *Digniori detur*, and so continued till the Degeneracy of Time, and the baneful Growth of Avarice and Pride, with the feverish Lust of Power, perverted it to—*Rapiat Fortior!*

Such, thro' a long Succession of Ages, was the Condition, and such at length the Fate of this Kingdom, destroyed after a longer Continuance than any other can boast, by the Abuse of its own Powers; a sure Argument that all created Beings, all sublunary Institutions, however wisely composed, in the very Essence of their Creation, and in the very Rudiments of their

Formation, comprehend, at the same Time, the Seeds of Dissolution: Yet it is not more remarkable than true, that in the most boisterous Periods of this Kingdom's antient Establishment, the Arts and Sciences, with the fundamental Principles of Constitution, were preserved and cherished with inviolable Assiduity. The Priests, Philosophers, Advocates, Annalists, Poets and Musicians, were obliged to preserve Religion, political Wisdom, Law, History, &c. hereditarily in their respective Tribes, and to educate in these different Branches the Chiefs and Nobles of the Land, for which they were graciously maintained in secure and splendid Tranquillity: Those Sages attended the National Conventions, where all publick Acts were religiously recorded, and all Abuses of Power and Government retrenched or reformed; nor were they permitted, except in Case of extraordinary Necessity, or uncommon Merit, to deviate from [pg 009] their proper and primitive Spheres of Action: Since, where an harmonious Subordination of Rank and Order hath not been duly preserved, even in free Estates, Liberty itself (wisely attempered, the greatest of all social Blessings) hath often, from Abuse and Neglect, sickened into Licentiousness, the immediate lewd Mother of Anarchy! In the visible Creation, the direct Result of infinite Wisdom, the lesser Planets do not interfere with, much less shock or oppose the Motions and Revolutions of the greater; they constantly keep the Distances first prescribed them, and all move regularly to their respective Ends. The most verdant and fragrant Meadows may, from the too frequent Irruption of muddy Waters, degenerate into noxious Marshes, if some Care was not taken to divert those impure Gushings into their proper Channels. Hence it may be inferred, that laying open the most honorary, as well as important and useful Professions of Society, to the Intrusion, or rather pyratrical Invasions, of the Scum and Dregs of the People, cannot, however varnished over with the fictitious Colourings of pretended Liberty, consist with true Political Wisdom.

Those ancient *Sophi* and *Literati* enjoyed their Places with the greater Security, that they were uninvadable by the inferior Classes of Mankind; with the greater Content and Chearfulness, that much Esteem and Emolument were connected with them: The Priest and Advocate informed and directed the Conscience and Conduct; the Historian and Annalist recorded the Institutions; the Poet and Musician celebrated and sung the Exploits of their Kings and Leaders: No Wonder then this Kingdom should

[pg 010] have been revered at Home, and admired Abroad; when Religion formed, Erudition nurtured, Philosophy strengthened, History preserved, Rhetorick adorned, Musick softened, and Poesy refined, the National Wisdom and Accomplishments; to all which was added, a thorough Knowledge of Tactics, and great Skill and Agility in all the athletick Arts, and bodily Exercises.

In the Versions of some original Codes exported by our Countryman, the learned and pious St. *Fiechry*, still extant in the *Navarre* Library at *Paris*, the Constitutional Wisdom of *Ireland* appears in a clear and happy Light: Persons, Things, Actions, and Expressions, were cautiously attended to, by the Laws; *Persons*, in their Minority, Youth, and Manhood, according to their different Ranks in the State, so as by Care, Education, and Discipline, to render them, some subservient, others useful, some beneficial, and others ornamental thereunto. *Things*, so carefully, as to prevent, by prohibitory Laws, Wastes of whatsoever Kind, and to ascertain to each Individual, as well as Society, their proper and distinct Rights. *Actions*, by directing those in general, and particular, to the Honour of the Deity and Welfare of the Community: *Expression*, by the penal Interdiction of prophane Cursing and Swearing, Obscenity, Scurrility, Calumny, and Detraction, yet with a full Indulgence of proper Satire against such as merited popular Reprehension, or Contempt; the Satirist's Pen in those Days being as much dreaded, or rather more so, than the Magistrate's Rod, and consequently as diligently avoided by a Demeanour absolutely irreproachable.

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It appeareth that, under the antient Government of *Ireland*, the Education of the landed Gentry, when Luxury, with its wasteful Catalogue of Vices, had not rendered Property so mutable and wavering as in modern Ages, was provided for; whether by the immediate Care of Parents, or essential Attention of Guardians, by the Laws of the Land; in order that Gentlemen should, to the Antiquity of Birth and Possession, add the important Dignity of Learning, and social Refinement of Arts: Since a Man at the Head of an original Estate, who should want the necessary Cultivation of Letters, was considered only as a Peasant in Disguise, and not more respected than a Hewer of Wood, or Drawer of Water.

In these Writings of St. *Fiechry*, the legislative Wisdom of *Olam-Fodla*; the philosophically-religious Capacity of *Cormac-O Quin*, who, from the pure Light of Nature, in a great Measure defeated the absurd *Polytheism* of the *Druids*; the consummate Integrity and Impartiality of *Federach* the Just, and *Moran* his Chief Justice; the Magnanimity of *Con-Ked-Cathagh*; the Conquests of *Kineth Mac Alpin*; the long, glorious, and peaceful Reign of *Conary* the Great, *coæval* with the Birth of our Blessed Lord and Saviour *Jesus Christ*, (undoubtedly the happiest, brightest, and most blissful Period the World ever saw;) are all displayed in a copious masterly Style, yet with strict chronological Exactness.

This learned St. *Fiechry* was Founder of the University in *Paris*, in the Beginning of the 8th Century. The better to enable him to carry on that noble Work, he obtained of *Charles* the Great a Tax on all Wheel-Carriages, within [pg 012] the Barriers of that City: Whence, a Hackney-Coach is at this Day technically term'd *Fiacre*.

Charles the Great, in order to repair the cruel and truly lamentable literary Dilapidations of the ferocious North-men, invited Numbers of the learned and pious *Irish* to the Continent, where he established and entertained them with Dignity, Tenderness, and Respect. In a curious Manuscript of *Nicholaus Gurtlerus*, (now in the *French King's Parisian Library*) Author of the *Origines Mundi*, where he alludes to these Times, you find the following favourable, but true Account of *Ireland*.—*Temporibus illis, barbaris Normannorum Cohortibus undequaque irrumpentibus, Religio, Fides, Philosophia, Virtus, Hospitalitas, Fortitudo, Castitas, necnon et Amœniores omnium generum Artes, Hibernia solummodò natali, veluti Solo, viguerunt*; little Wonder that *Ireland* should have been esteemed the *Ierne*, or sacred Isle of the *Greeks*, the *Insula Sanctorum*, or Island of Saints of the *Romans*.—Would to Heaven our Countrymen had, upon all considerable Occasions, recollected those deserved Encomiums, thereby to approve them worthy their applauded Origin, and native Soil!

We now proceed to consider *Ireland* in her happiest and brightest View, after the Admission and Propagation of Christianity. It is certain there were many Christians in *Ireland*, before the Arrival of *Palladius* in 431, or of St. *Patrick* the Year following: St. *Kieran*, St. *Ailbe*, St. *Declan*, and St. *Ibar*,

whom *Ussher* calls the Precursors, or Forerunners of *St. Patrick*, are pregnant Proofs of this; they were of the Birth of *Ireland*, from whence they travelled to *Rome*, in Search of Education and Learning, where [pg 013] they lived some Years, were ordained, and returned Home about the Year 402.

It seems that those early Preachers confined their Labours to particular Places, in which they had considerable Success, but fell very short of converting the Body of the Nation: However, they sowed the Seed which *St. Patrick* came after to water: And it is certain that *St. Patrick* was so well satisfied with the Progress they made, in their particular Districts in *Munster*, that this was the last Province in *Ireland* he thought proper to visit. That there were many Christians in *Ireland*, at this Period, seems to be confirmed by *Prosper*, who, in giving an Account of the Mission of *Palladius*, says, that he was ordained by Pope *Celestin*, and sent the first Bishop to the Scots believing in Christ. This Passage can mean nothing else, but that *Palladius*, born in Britain, was sent to the Scots [i.e. the *Irish*] who had already formed Churches under *Kieran*, *Ailbe*, *Declan* and *Ibar*; and so the Bishop of *St. Asaph* expounds it. This then was the next Attempt that was made for the Conversion of the *Irish*: *Palladius* engaged in a more ample and extensive Design than his Predecessors, yet he failed in the Execution of it, stay'd but a short Time in *Ireland*, and did little worth remembring; he converted, however, a few, and is said to have founded three Churches; but he had neither Courage to withstand the Fierceness of the heathen *Irish*, nor Abilities, for Want of the Language, proper for the Work.

Nathi, the Son of *Garcon*, an *Irish* Prince, opposed his preaching; upon which *Palladius* left the Kingdom, and died in the Land of the *Picts*, on the 15th of *December*, 431. This [pg 014] glorious Work was reserved for *St. Patrick*, to whose holy Life, divine Mission, and extraordinary Success, I refer the Reader. This great Apostle of the *Irish* founded and built the Cathedral Church of *Ardmagh*, about the Year 444, or 45, which, from that early Period to this, hath continued the Metropolitan Church of all *Ireland*. So that 1194 Years passed away from the Founding of the City of *Rome*, to that of *Ardmagh*.

The various and most signal Blessings derived to this Nation, from the salutary Mission of this illustrious Saint, require, in Gratitude, our giving the Reader yet a further Account of the Author of such Happiness and Glory to *Ireland*.

He was born in the extreme Bounds of *Britain*, (in that Part thereof which is now comprehended within the Limits of the modern *Scotland*) at a Village called *Banaven*, in the Territory of *Tabernia*, (as he himself saith in his Confession) in *Vico Banaven Taberniæ*, &c. He tells us that he was born of a good Family. *Ingennuus fui secundum Carnem*. His Father was *Calphurnius*, a Deacon, who was the Son of *Potitus*, a Priest; from whence may be clearly inferred that the Clergy were not restrained from Matrimony in that Age. He was just advanced into his sixteenth Year, when he was taken Captive, the Manner of which is thus related by St. *Evin* and others: His Father, Mother, Brother, and five Sisters, undertook a Voyage to *Aremorick Gaul*, (now called *Bass Bretagne*) to visit the Relations of his Mother *Couchessa*. It happened about this Time, that the seven Sons of *Factmude*, a *British* Prince, were banished, and took to the Sea; that, making an Inroad into *Aremorick Gaul*, they took *Patrick* [pg 015] and his Sister, *Lupita*, (some say *Tigrida* also) Prisoners. They brought their Captives to the North of *Ireland*, and sold *Patrick* to *Milcho Mac Huanan*, a Prince of *Dalaradia*: Others tell the Story in a different Manner, and with a stronger Degree of Probability. That the *Romans* having deserted *Britain*, to preserve their own Country from the barbarous Incursions of the *Northern Hive*, the *Irish* made frequent Conquests, in *North Britain* especially, whence returning victorious, in one of those Expeditions among others brought *Patrick* Captive. But in this they all agree, and he himself confirms it, that he continued Prisoner in *Ireland* six Years; he was sold to *Milcho* and his three Brothers, which gave Occasion of his changing his Name into *Cathraigh*, or rather *Ceathir-Tigh*, because he served four Masters; *Ceathir* signifying four, and *Tigh* a House or Family. *Milcho* observing the Care and Diligence of his new Servant, bought out the Shares of his Brothers, and made him his own Property. He sent him to feed his Hogs on *Sliev-Mis*. And St. *Patrick* himself tells us his Behaviour in this Office.

“My constant Business was to feed the Hogs. I was frequent in Prayer; the Love and Fear of God more and more inflamed my Heart; my Faith was

enlarged, and my Spirit augmented, so that I said an hundred Prayers by Day, and almost as many by Night. I arose before Day to my Prayers, in the Snow, in the Frost, and in the Rain, and yet I received no Damage; nor was I affected with Slothfulness; for then the Spirit of God was warm within me.” It was here he perfected himself in the *Irish* Language, the wonderful Providence of God visibly appearing in this Instance of his [pg 016] Captivity, that he should have the Opportunity in his tender Years of becoming well acquainted with the Language, Manners, and Dispositions of that People, to whom he was intended as a future Apostle. He continued six whole Years in Servitude, and in the seventh was released. There seems to have been a Law in *Ireland* for this Purpose, agreeable to the Institution of *Moses*, that a Servant should be released the seventh Year.

Having parted from his Master, after a great Variety of Distresses, he at length arrived to his Parents, who received him with extraordinary Joy; with these he remained two Years, and probably would much longer, had he not by a Vision been quickened to a more active and glorious Life. In this he thought he saw a Man coming to him from *Ireland*, whose Name was *Victoricus*, with a great Number of Letters; that he gave him one of them to read, in the Beginning of which were contained these Words, *Vox-Hiberionacum*, the Voice of the *Irish*: While he was reading this Letter, he thought the same Moment, that he heard the Voice of the Inhabitants who lived near the Wood of *Foclut*, in the Barony of *Tyr-Awley*, and County of *Mayo*, hard by the Western Sea, crying to him with an audible and distinct Voice, “We intreat thee, holy Youth, to come and walk among us.” He was greatly amazed at this Vision, and awoke; it animated him, however, to his future Studies and heavenly Progress; so far even, that he tells us himself, he thanked God, that after many Years he had dealt with the *Irish*, according to their crying out.

These early Scenes of this great Saint's Life, should, among many others, serve as lessons of [pg 017] Charity, Consideration, and Humility, to the Rich, the Great, the Proud, and the Wanton; who may recollect that, altho' he was well born, he was nevertheless, in the most vigorous Season of Life, a Slave and a Swine-Herd: Happy, though wretched Servitude! In which, his leisure Hours, mostly employed in Christian Confidence and Prayer, made him so signally the Favourite of Heaven, that from those cloudy

Dawnings, he in Process of Time became a learned Doctor, a sanctified Missioner, a venerable Prelate, an eminent Primate, a national Apostle, and the bright Instructor of Kings! Such were the fruitful Rewards of uninterrupted unshaken Devotion, Piety, and Zeal! From this Time he formed the steady Resolution of converting the *Irish*; and, the better to accomplish the heavenly Task, he undertook a laborious Journey to foreign Countries, to enrich his Mind with Learning and Experience.

He continued abroad thirty-five Years, pursuing his Studies under the Direction principally of his Mother's Uncle, St. *Martin*, Bishop of *Tours*, who had ordained him Deacon; and after his Death, partly with St. *German*, Bishop of *Auxerre*, (who ordained him a Priest, and called his Name *Magonius*, which was the third Name he was known by,) partly among a Colony of *Hermits* and *Monks*, in some Islands of the *Tuscan* Sea; and he employed a good Part of the Time in the City of *Rome*, among the Canons Regular of the *Lateran* Church: At length, having his Soul thoroughly tempered with religious Virtue, enlightened with the true Evangelical Faith, and his Understanding enlarged by the most profitable and edifying Studies, he arrived in *Ireland* about the 60th [pg 018] Year of his Age; and in the Year of our Lord 432, landed in the County of *Wicklow*, where he began his Ministry, by the Conversion of *Sinel*, a great Man in that Country, the Grandson of *Finchad*, who ought to be remembered, as he was the first Fruits of St. *Patrick's* Mission in *Ireland*; he was the 8th in lineal Descent from *Cormac*, King of *Leinster*, and came afterwards to be enumerated among the Saints of *Ireland*.

From this Country he sailed to an Island on the Coast of the County of *Dublin*, called after him *Inis Phadring*, and by the *English*, *Holm Patrick* at this Day, where he and his faithful Companions rested after their Fatigues. From *Inis Phadring*, he sailed Northward to that Part of *Ulster* called *Ulidia*, and put in at *Inbherstaying* Bay. When he and his Fellow Labourers landed, *Dichu*, the Son of *Trichem*, Lord of the County, being informed that they were Pirates, came out with armed Men in order to kill them: But being struck with the venerable Appearance of St. *Patrick*, he gave him Audience, and listened attentively to the Word of Life preached by him; he changed his wicked Purpose, believed, and was baptized, and brought over all his Family to the Faith: It is further observed of him, that he was the first

Person in *Ulster*, who embraced Christianity. He dedicated the Land whereon his Conversion was wrought to the Service of God, where a Church was erected, changed after to an eminent Monastery. He travelled hence by Land to *Clunebois* in *Dalaradia*, to endeavour the Conversion of his old Master *Milcho*, whose Service he had left thirty-eight Years before; but this obstinate Prince, hearing of the great Success of St. *Patrick's* preaching, and ashamed to be persuaded [pg 019] in his old Age, to forsake the Religion of his Ancestors, (by one especially who had been his Servant, in a most inferior Station,) made a funeral Pile of his House and Goods, and by the Instigation of the Enemy of Mankind, burned himself therein: Thus ended *Milcho McHuanan*.

Hence St. *Patrick* returned to *Inis*, the Habitation of *Dichu*, and in his Journey converted great Numbers to the true Faith of *Christ*. In some time, he took his Leave of *Dichu*, and bent his course Southward by Sea, keeping the Coast on his Right-hand, and arrived at Port *Colbdi*, where he landed, and committed the Care of his Vessel to his Nephew *Luman*, desiring him to wait for him there forty Days, while he and his Disciples were travelling in the inner Parts of the Country to preach the Gospel. His Intention in this Journey was, to celebrate the Festival of *Easter* in the Plains of *Bregia*, and to be in the Neighbourhood of the Great Triennial Convention at *Tarah*, which at this Season was held by King *Leogair*, and all his Tributary Princes, Nobles, *Druids*, *Annalists*, and *Fileas*. St. *Patrick* wisely foreseeing that whatever Impressions he should make on this august Assembly must have an Influence on the whole Kingdom, and therefore, being supported with invincible Christian Fortitude, resolved not to be absent from a Place where his Presence was so conducive to the Ends of his Holy Ministry.

Never did the Spirit of popular Freedom exert itself more powerfully or harmoniously, than in those truly parliamentary Triennial Conventions of *Ireland*, where the supreme Monarch, the Provincial Kings, the feudatory Lords, the Nobles, landed Men, *Druids*, &c. by the [pg 020] unbiased Suffrages of the People, convened for the Peace, good Government and Security of each particular Province, as well as those of the whole Kingdom. Many Centuries had this wise Constitution subsisted here, before our Neighbours, even of *South Britain*, knew any thing relative to Houses,

or Raiment; it being notorious that so late as the Arrival of *Julius Cæsar* among them, they painted their Bodies, to render them terrible, and lived in the open Fields. It is really somewhat surprizing that People so near in Situation, should differ so essentially in Disposition, as the Inhabitants of those Islands have in all Ages; Hospitality having been the distinguishing Attribute of the *Irish*, and it's opposite Defect, that of the *Britons*; the Account given of them by *Horace* 1700 and odd Years ago, *Visam Britannes Hospitibus feros*, being as literally applicable to them at this Day, where the Force of Education doth not operate to mitigate their natural Ferocity.

But to return: St. *Patrick* in his Way to *Tarah*, took up his Lodgings at the House of the hospitable *Sesgnen* in *Meath*, who kindly received and welcomed him. St. *Patrick* preach'd Christ and his Gospel to him; he believed, and was baptized with his whole Family.

From the House of *Sesgnen*, he moved Westward, and arrived on *Easter Eve* at *Fierta-fir-feic*, on the Northern Banks of the River *Boyne*, where he rested, resolving there to prepare for the next Day's Solemnity. It was penal for any Person at the Time of the Celebration of this solemn Convention at *Tarah*, to kindle a Fire in the Province, before the King's Bonfire first appeared. I am of Opinion this was a religious Ceremony, as the chief Deity of the ancient Inhabitants, [pg 021] in exterior Worship especially, was *Bel*, or *Belus*; whence *Apollo* or *Ap-haul*, the Son of the Sun, whom they emblematically worshipped, by those fiery Offerings; whence the first Day of *May*, peculiarly dedicated to this *Bel*, is even now in *Irish*, called *Lha-Bel-Thinih*, and probably from the same Source may be derived the Custom of lighting up Bonfires, and Sops, on the Eve of the 24th Day of *June*. St. *Patrick* however, either not knowing or not minding this Ceremony, lighted up a Fire before his Booth, which altho' eight Miles distant from *Tarah*, was very visible. It was seen with Astonishment from Court, and the *Druids* informed the King, that if he did not immediately extinguish the Fire, he who kindled it, and his Successors, should for ever hold the Principality of *Ireland*; which hath hitherto turned out a true Prediction of those Heathen Priests, in a Primatial and Spiritual Principality.

The King dispatched Messengers to bring *Patrick* before him, and gave his positive Orders, that nobody should presume to rise out of his Seat, or pay him the least Honour: But *Ere*, the Son of *Dego*, ventured to disobey this Command; he arose, and offered the Holy Father his Seat. St. *Patrick* preached to him and converted him. He became a Person of eminent Sanctity, and after some Time was consecrated by St. *Patrick*, Bishop of *Slain*.

The Day following, when St. *Patrick* and two of his Disciples appeared unexpectedly at Court, and preached to the King and his Nobles, *Dubtach*, the King's Poet Laureat, payed Honour and Respect to the Saint, and was converted by his Preaching. *Fiech*, a young Poet, who was under the Tuition of *Dubtach*, was also converted, [pg 022] and afterwards made Bishop of *Sletty*, and is said to have been the Author of a celebrated Poem, composed in Praise of St. *Patrick*. *Anselm*, Arch-Bishop of *Canterbury*, relates the Conversion of *Tingar*, the Son of *Clito*, (one of the Nobles in this Assembly,) in the same Manner. The Queen also, and many others of the Court, became Christians; and altho' the King held out for a long Time with great Obstinacy, yet at last he submitted to be baptized. St. *Patrick* is said here to have wrought many Miracles: There could not truly, even according to the Purposes of human Wisdom, have happened a more solemn or weighty Occasion, for God Almighty's supporting this Holy Preacher by Miracles, than when the collective Body of the whole Nation was assembled together; from whose Report and Conviction, the Influences of his blessed Works and Doctrine must of Course spread through the whole Kingdom.

His Conduct and Proceedings here, with a particular Detail of the Miracles wrought by him, may be had at large in the History of his Life, published by *John Colgan*.

From *Tarah*, the Saint proceeded next to *Talten*, not far from thence, at the Season of the Royal Diversions: Here he preached to *Cairbre*, and *Conall*, the two Brothers of King *Leogin*; the former received him with great Indignity, and perversely shut his Ears against his Doctrine; but *Conall* believed, and was baptized, and gave St. *Patrick* a Place to build a Church on.

This *Conall* was Great-Grand-Father to *Columb-Kill*. He spent the Remainder of this Year in *Meath* and *Louth*, and the Districts adjoining, preaching, and converting great Numbers of People. The *Taltenian* Sports above-mentioned, [pg 023] have been much celebrated by the *Irish* Historians, and Antiquaries. They were a kind of warlike Exercises, somewhat resembling the *Olympick* Games, consisting of Racing, Tilts, Tournaments, Wrestling, Leaping, Vaulting, and all other manly and martial Exercises, which gave Rise to the many hyperbolical Tales, formerly related of those *Taltenian* Sports. They were exhibited every Year at *Talten*, a Mountain in *Meath*, for fifteen Days before, and fifteen Days after the First of *August*. Their first Institution is ascribed to *Lughaid-lam-fadha*, the twelfth King of *Ireland*, who began his Reign A. M. 2764 (a sufficient Proof of *Ireland's* Antiquity as a Kingdom). They were ordained by *Lughaid*, in Gratitude to the Memory of *Tailte*, the Daughter of *Magh-More*, (a Prince of some Part of *Spain*) who having been married to *Eochaid*, King of *Ireland*, took the same *Lughaid* under her Protection, and had the Care of his Education in his Minority. From this Princess both the Sports, and the Place where they were celebrated, took their Names: From *Lughaid*, the First of *August* was called *Lugnasa*, or the Memory of *Lughaid*, *Nasa* signifying Memory, in the *Irish* Language.

In the Year of the World 2700, *Gideon* then reigning fourth Judge of the *Hebrews*, appear'd many Heroes, as *Hercules*, *Orpheus*, *Castor*, *Pollux*, the *Argonauts*, *Jason*, *Laomedon*, *Thesæus*, *Dedalus*, &c. The *Amazones*, Heroines of *Scythic* Extraction, having lost their Husbands in Battle, took up Arms themselves, with a manly Spirit of Resentment, and (inspired with Love of their deceased Husbands, and Grief for so great and irretrievable a Loss!) subdued *Asia*, and built *Ephesus*. *Hercules* and *Thesæus* waged [pg 024] War against those Heroines, and defeated them, more to the Glory of the Vanquished than their own, those Matrons having defended themselves with surprizing Resolution. They cut off the Guards set over them, and escaped the Severity and Pride of their Conquerors. *Hercules*, in Honour of such extraordinary heroick Females, instituted the *Olympick* Games; as likewise did *Thesæus*, the *Isthmian*, in the Year of the World, about 2700, the *Taltenian* Sports, the very same with the *Olympick*, brought sixty-four Years after from *Spain* into *Ireland*, by *Tailte*, and her Followers. Now this *Tailte*, Queen of *Ireland*, was the Grand-daughter of an *Amazon* Princess,

those immortal Females having, with their Progeny, Friends and Followers, to avoid the ruinous Hostilities of *Hercules* and *Thesæus*, sought Shelter in *Spain*, whither they imported the Learning of *Trismegistus*, the Grandson of *Mercury*, and Glory of *Ægypt*, together with all the literary Arts derived into *Greece*, from *Phœnicia*, by *Cadmus*, the Brother of *Europa*, about the Year of the World 2530, *Othoniel* then reigning the first Judge of the *Hebrews*. The Posterity of this ancient and illustrious Colony, about the Year of the World 3000, (*Solomon* then reigning with great Splendour, third King of the *Hebrews*) settled in this Kingdom, as before observed: So that, by an impartial Estimate of Dates, Periods, and Facts, our Origin is well ascertained, our early Possession of Letters, wise Policy, and the politer Arts, proved, and the Remark of an *Italian* Monk in the 7th Century, from the University of *Mongret*, in an Epistle to his Correspondent at *Rome*, justified, *Nil mirum Populum hunc Celtico Scythicum è præclarâ Amazonidum stirpê oriundum, verâ Religionê et [pg 025] incorruptâ Fide illuminatum, sapientia Doctrina optimisque Morbidus ornatum, viros fortes et Fæminas castas plerumque procreare*. A Rescript of this Original Epistle still extant, in the *Vatican* Library, some Years ago in the Hands of Father *Don Levy*, may therefore, I believe, be found in the College of *Lombard* at *Paris*.

In this shining Period were Cathedrals and Churches erected, Universities founded and established, Colleges, Seminaries and Schools propagated in many Parts of this Kingdom, which, at the same Time, became a peaceful and hospitable Retreat to religious and learned Men, disturbed on the Continent of *Europe*, by the frequent Invasions, and cruel Hostilities of the North-men, whose Piracies and Barbarity, even *Ireland* could not always escape! For, from the Time of *Artigrius*, Archbishop of *Ardmagh* in 822, for near 200 Years the cruel *Danes* miserably ravaged this Kingdom, destroying, by Fire and Sword, every Establishment, as well of Piety as Learning, (to both which, and to all religious Maxims of civilized Society, they had been avowed implacable Enemies) till they were themselves, in 1014, totally defeated at *Clontarf*, by the invincible Arms of the Great Monarch, *Bryan Borou*, from whom descended a Race conspicuous for exemplary Prelates, heroick Leaders, and steady Patriots.

The learned Author of the *Dissertations* before-mentioned, charges this Hero with a Violation of the Constitution of his Country: Yet the Violation seems of far earlier Date, when the supreme Monarchy was, by the *Hugonian* Law, inalienably united to one Family, whose Sovereignty, however founded originally, whether by Birth, or Election, was essential to the public [pg 026] Welfare: For we must allow that the Preservation of the People is the principal Law to which all others are subordinate. *Salus Populi suprema Lex*; and equally, that not only the Necessities, but the Safety also of the People, at that Time of Danger and Distraction, eagerly called forth the Conduct and Valour, the protective and restorative Abilities of that great and virtuous Man, of whom a faithful Historian, in his Detail of the Battle of *Clontarf*, says; *Integrâ prius adept a Victoriâ rebus humanis eodem Diê excessit vir Bellô ac Pacê summus, Justitiæ, Religionis, Literarum, Cultor eximius, et cum Carolo Magno utique comparandus.*

In the 239th Page of the *Dissertations*, the excellent Author expresseth himself as follows:

“I now proceed to give some Account of the second Royal House of *Scots*, the oldest of the *Milesian* Race, and the Posterity of *Eber*.” This Race then being avowed the oldest, in Respect of Primogeniture, must, of Course, have been prior in Point of Dignity and Sway, or at least, equally entitled to the Election of the People to such Ranks; were not those by violent Measures annexed to the *Heremonian* Line: Yet, however this might have been, certain it is, that no Houses that we read of, ancient or modern, have produced a greater Number of truly heroick Princes, or of longer Continuance, than those of the North and South *Hy-Nial*; from whom also issued many noble Families of real Worth, and equal Renown. With *Bryan*, the happy Genius of *Ireland*, in a great Measure, expired: For the cruel *Danes* had, for near 200 Years before, so wofully overturned the Universities of *Ardmagh*, *Dondaleith-Glass*, *Mongret*, and *Lismore*, with all other Seminaries of Piety [pg 027] and Learning, (the only genuine Sources of national Greatness, Concord, good Discipline, and Happiness) had obliged, in the 8th Century, so many learned Men to seek that Shelter and Security on the Continent, which the barbarous Hostilities, and impious Manners of those Northerners, denied them at Home; had made such frequent lamentable Breaches in the antient, wise Constitution of the Kingdom; had,

by the fatal Example of their profligate dissolute Lives, so vitiated the national Morality; and finally, had left behind them so many noxious Seeds of Faction and Anarchy, as, in less than two Centuries, gave up a Kingdom, of above 2000 Years Establishment, the unaccountable Prey of a few adventurous *Normans*!

Patrick governed the See of *Dublin* about ten Years, and, in a Voyage to *England*, perished by Shipwreck, in the *British* Sea, on the 16th of *October*, 1084; having been sent to *Lanfranc*, Archbishop of *Canterbury*, by King *Tirdelvac*.

Donat, or *Dongus O'Haingly*, having spent some Time in the Study of useful Learning in *Ireland*, went over into *England*, and became a Benedictine Monk at *Canterbury*. He was afterwards, (by the Consent of King *Tirdelvac*, and the Clergy of *Dublin*) consecrated, A. D. 1085, in the Cathedral of *Canterbury*, by the before-mentioned *Lanfranc*, to whom he made the following Profession of Obedience:

“I, *Donat*, Bishop of the See of *Dublin* in *Ireland*, do promise Canonical Obedience to you, *O' Lanfranc*, Archbishop of the holy Church of *Canterbury*, and to your Successors.”

It is evident that the Title of the Kings of *England* to this Kingdom, by Papal Donation, [pg 028] or Appointment, was very insufficient, if not absolutely trifling: Nor could a Right of Conquest be urged in any Period of the Reign of *Henry* the Second, or his Descendants. But the Great and Royal Families of *Ireland*, long the Prey of Faction, deliberately preferred a limited and stipulated Submission to foreign Authority, to the various Evils arising from intestine Feuds and Animosities; and this, had the wise Conditions thereof been constantly attended to, with mutual Observance, had been a sound Title, well and judiciously founded.

True it is, that after the Surrender of the Crown by King *John* to the See of *Rome*, the Pope exerted some temporal Authority in this Kingdom, instanced in his having created *Mc. Con More Mc. Namaras*² Duke of *Klan Cullane*, a Man of great Valour and Piety, supported by ample Possessions in the Baronies of *Tulla* and *Bunratty*, in the County of *Clare*; which extensive Districts entirely belonged to that ancient, hospitable, martial, and

religious Race, of which *Mc. Con More* was Chief: The *Mc. Namaras*, more or less, have in all Ages made, and still continue to make, a distinguished Figure, as well in the Field, as in the learned Professions; and were formerly so warlike a People, that of themselves they formed an heroic Cavalry, justly stiled the *Phalanx* of that Part of *Ireland* wherein they resided.

How our Neighbours came to call us *waild Ayrish*, I am a Loss to conjecture; it being evident [pg 029] we have been a thousand Years, at least, in Possession of Letters, Laws, and Civility, before the Arrival of *Julius Cæsar* in *Britain*.

I am equally at a Loss to know why a Man should become a standing Jest for his Ignorance in an alien Tongue, almost the constant Fate of our Countrymen in *Britain*, where, whoever is not smartly expert in the *English* Language, is immediately denominated a *Teague*, a *Paddy*, or I know not what, in the Stile of Derision: At the same Time that the most awkward-tongued *Irishman* in *London* speaks *English* with far more Propriety, and a better Accent, than the smartest *British Petit Maitre* in *Paris* doth *French*.

Some dramattick Scriblers, (probably of our own degenerate Growth) the better to qualify them for eleemosinary Dinners, gave Rise to this impertinent Treatment of a Nation, which, from the concurrent Testimonies of all the Dispassionate and Learned, can, in Reality, be as little the Object of Scurrility, as any other.

Why should even poor *Teague* prove so constant a Butt, to Farce-wrights, and Hackney Laughters; when, upon Examination, he is, by a thousand Degrees, preferable to the *British* Hobbino, or *French* Gregoire? For *Teague* is a very Pattern of Hospitality; so much so, that if a Gentleman should happen to miss his Road, and be necessitated to seek the Shelter of *Teague's* Cabbin, or Hut, was poor *Teague* trusting to two Sheep for his worldly Subsistence, he would kill one, and sell the other, at the next Village or Inn, for the better Entertainment of his Guest, and think himself happy in such an Occasion of approving his Generosity and Respect: He would the next Morning abandon his Spade, and chearfully trot ten Miles to shew [pg 030] such bewilder'd Gentleman the right Road. He is naturally civil, generous, and hospitable, (for scarce a Night passeth that poor Travellers are not entertained in his Cottage,) extremely respectful to his

Superiors, and to his Lord and Master faithful to Death. The military Annals of *Europe* proclaim his Capacity and Taste for Fighting; then if you should take this identical *Teague's* infant Son, and give him a regular liberal Education, it is one hundred to one, but he turns out a Gentleman of Merit, Learning, Worth, and Politeness; whereas it would certainly require more than *Herculean* Labour to chissel a *French Paisan*, a primitive *Westmoreland*, or *Devonshire* Boor, not only into the Form of an elegant, but even into that of a sociable Creature.

The Insignificancy of those Jesters and Spatterers, will more clearly appear, if we look back to the wise, free, and truly parliamentary Constitution of this Kingdom; if we recollect the vast Length of its Duration, as a free and independant State; the military Prowess of its Inhabitants in all Ages; their victorious Conflicts with the *Romans*, and with the *French* under *Henry the Vth*, and the *Black Prince*; their having founded a Monarchy in *North Britain*, whence, by a Right of Descent, in Addition to every other, his present Majesty, (whom God long preserve,) by the special Providence and infinite Mercy of Heaven, ruleth over us: If we consider the Number of our Universities, Colleges, and Academies, religious Monasteries and pious Seminaries, resorted to from all civilized Parts of *Europe*, our Metropolitcal and Diocesan Cathedrals; on such impartial Review, surely, the foregoing Tribe of Sneerers [pg 031] and Flouters must dwindle into deserved Contempt.

I shall close this feeble Attempt on the antient State of *Ireland*, with the Description thereof by *Donat*, Bishop of *Fesulæ*, near *Florence*, in the 7th or 8th Century; referring, at the same Time, to the most authentick *British* Antiquaries, *Campden*, *Giraldus Cambrensis*, *Buchanan*, *Ware*, &c. for Confirmation of what hath been previously observed on the same Subject.

*Finibus Occiduis describitur optima Tellus,
Nomine et Antiquis SCOTIA scripta Libris—
Insula dives Opum, Gemmarum, Vestis et Auri,
Commoda Corporibus, Aere sole Solo;
Melle fluit pulchris et lacteis SCOTIA Campis
Vestibus atque Armis, frugibus, arte viris.
Ursorum Rabies, nulla est ibi; sæva Leonum*

*Semina, nec unquam SCOTICA Terra tulit
Nulla Venena nocent, nec Serpens serpit in Herbâ,
Nec conquesta canit Garula Rana Lacu;
In qua SCOTORUM Gentes habitare merentur
Inclita Gens Hominum Milite, Pace, Fide.*

Thus Englished by the Ingenius and Reverend Mr. *Dunkin*:

“Far Westward, lies an Isle of antient Fame,
By Nature bless'd, and SCOTIA is her Name;
Enroll'd in Books: Exhaustless is her Store
Of veiny Silver, and of Golden Ore:
Her fruitful Soil for ever teams with Wealth,
With Gems her Waters, and her Air with Health:
Her verdant Fields with Milk and Honey flow;
Her woolly Fleeces vie with Virgin Snow:
[pg 032]
Her waving Furrows float with bearded Corn,
And Arms and Arts her envy'd Sons adorn.
No savage Bear, with lawless Fury, roves;
No rav'nous Lion, thro' her peaceful Groves;
No Poison there infects; no scaly Snake
Creeps thro' the Grass, nor Frog annoys the Lake:
An Island worthy of its pious Race,
In War triumphant, and unmatch'd in Peace.”

This *Donat*, Bishop of *Fesula*, was an *Irishman*, of the antient and hospitable Family, afterwards *O Hogan*; a Family which held ample and fair Possessions in the Province of *Munster*, and which, in former Times, adorned the See of *Killaloe*, with four very learned and exemplary Prelates; namely, with *Matthew O Hogan*, who succeeded to this Bishoprick, in the Reign of *Henry the III*d, and in the Year of our Lord 1267; and who, having much enlarged his Diocese, and done many signal Acts of popular Charity, died in the Year, 1281, and was buried in *Limerick*, in a Convent of *Dominican* Friars. To this Bishop succeeded *Maurice O Hogan*, who governed this See with peculiar Zeal and Charity, upwards of sixteen Years, and died in 1298, or the Year following, and was buried in his own Church.

Thomas O Hogan, Canon of *Killaloe*, was consecrated in 1343, and died on the 30th of *October*, 1354; five Days after which, he was buried among his worthy Ancestors at *Nenagh*; as may be seen in the Annals of that Place.

Richard O Hogan succeeded to the See of *Killaloe*, in 1525, and was in 1539 translated to *Clon Mac Nois*: He was a Prelate of great [pg 033] Learning and Capacity, in all spiritual and ecclesiastical Matters.

This antient Family is, at this Time, represented by *Edmund O Hogan*, Esq; High Sheriff of the County of *Clare*, a Gentleman, who, by the whole Tenor of his Life, hath proved Generosity of Heart, Charity, and Hospitality, to be Qualities inherent.

Dermod Mac Murchad, sovereign Prince of *Hy-Kinsellagh*, banished by *Roderick O Connor*, King of *Ireland*, for his various and high State Crimes, sought Sanctuary and Redress in the Court of *England*; where, in the Absence of *Henry*, then in *Normandy*, diverse adventurous *Normans*, *Flemings*, *Saxons*, and old *Britons*, (being themselves unsettled, and unestablished) acceded to the Fate and Fortunes of *Dermod*, under the Conduct of *Strongbow*, Earl of *Pembroke*; whose casual Success in *Ireland*, against *Roderick* (owing more to the general Defection, at that fatal Period, of the *Irish* Chiefs against their lawful Sovereign, than to any superior Valour or Address of those Adventurers) induced *Henry* to a deliberate and grand Invasion of a Kingdom, to which he could lay no Claim on the Score of Nature, Reason, or Right, and whither his pretended Mission, on the Score of collecting *St. Peter's* Dues, (which *St. Peter* himself never once thought of, or imagined) was as ridiculous as groundless. The *Summa Dies*, however, arrived: and the People of *Ireland*, wearied out with intestine Strife, acknowledged *Henry* for their Sovereign Lord; and a grand Charter of Rights and Covenants, mutual Protection and Allegiance, was entered into, anteriorly to that of *England*. How well this Charter was observed on the protective Side, the absolute Anarchy of [pg 034] near four Centuries, from its original Date and Perfection, to the Reign of Queen *Elizabeth*, demonstrates: A whole Nation, that sought Protection, and that agreed for quiet, regular, and lawful Government, upon rationable Terms, deprived of the Power of ordaining Laws for its own Security and Well-being, and precluded (all to four or five great and favourite Families) from the Benefits

and Advantages accruing from those of that Kingdom, to which it had voluntarily united itself; exposed, through such a Length of Time, to arbitrary Depredations, and unpunished, unredressed, uncensured Rapine, *Quis talia sando temperet a Lachrymis!*

King *Henry* called back into *England*, to lay the Storms raised by his rebellious Sons, with whom and *Thomas Becket*, Archbishop of *Canterbury*, he was so constantly embroiled to the End of his Life, that he could little attend to the Settlement of the Affairs of this new acquired Sovereignty.

Richard the First, his immediate Successor, called away to the Holy Wars against the *Saracens*, had as little Leisure as his Predecessor to promote the Quiet, or Happiness of *Ireland*.

From the usurped Authority of King *John*, a continued Series of Papal Animosity, Bloodshed, Calamities and Piracies, closed at last by Poison; little beside political Disasters of all Sorts, could be expected.

Henry the Third, through a Reign of Fifty-six Years, was continually involved in Troubles and Hostilities, with his inflexible *English* Barons.

Edward the First, a great and warlike Prince, was, throughout his whole Reign, engaged in the Reduction of the *Welch* and *Scots*, and so [pg 035] intent thereon, that he could turn his Thoughts to no other Object.

Edward the Second, indeed, sent *Gaveston* hither, more to screen him from the implacable Resentments of the stubborn *English* Nobility, than to render any good Offices to the Inhabitants of this Country; who, indiscriminately, (*Strongbow*nians as well as *Irish*) felt the Severity of that insolent Favourite's Measures.

Richard the Second visited this Kingdom in Person, with the good Intentions of establishing Peace, Order, and Harmony, in a valuable but long neglected Estate: Yet his own adverse Fate, conspiring with that of this Land, called him back, before he could carry his favourable Resolutions into Execution, to defend his *English* Dominions from the hostile Attacks of *Henry*, Earl of *Hereford*, who, with the Duke of *Norfolk*, Son to *John* of *Gaunt*, had some Years before been banished by *Richard*, to prevent a

personal Combat: This King, worthy more propitious Stars, long agitated and afflicted by the Turbulence and irreconcilable Obstinacy of his *British* Subjects, perished at last under the impious Hands of Sir *Pierce* of *Exton*, who, at the Head of eight barbarous armed Assassins, rushed into his Chamber, and murdered him.

The Reign of *Henry* the Fourth was short, tumultuous, and bloody; Deluges of noble Blood having been shed by the bare Hands of the common Executioner, to confirm a Throne acquired by abominable Crimes, and Violence! And no sooner had these dreadful Storms begun to abate, than *Henry* was forced to depart from a Scene he had more adorned, (for he was, without Question, a great and valiant Man) [pg 036] had not his Ambition blindly hurried him beyond the Bounds of Justice and Nature.

Henry the Fifth, his Son and Successor, and truly Inheritor of his Ambition and warlike Genius, imagining himself aggrieved by the *Salique Law*, which excluded his Great Great-Grandmother, *Isabel*, from the Monarchy of *France*, turned his elevated Thoughts intirely to the Conquest of that Kingdom: Wherein, by his own vast Merit in martial Affairs, and the Co-operation of the Queen of *France*, (Consort of *Charles* the Sixth, then frantick,) and that of the Duke of *Burgundy*, a great and powerful Prince, he so far succeeded, as, after his Marriage with *Catharine de Valois*, Daughter of *Charles* the Sixth, to be crowned, and acknowledged King of *France*.

To this great and victorious Monarch succeeded *Henry* the Sixth, who, through a long, various, and constantly clouded Reign, seemed the very Play of Fortune! This Day a King, the next a Prisoner! One Day acknowledged by his Parliament, the next attainted! One Day a Conqueror, and the next a Captive!

Fierce, frequent, and bloody, were the Conflicts between the Houses of *York* and *Lancaster*, the *White* and *Red Roses*; the former endeavouring to recover its Loss, the latter to maintain its usurped Authority. In this dreadful Quarrel perished two hundred thousand of private Soldiers; ten thousand of the Nobility, Gentry, and Persons of Distinction; three Kings; and, at last, the entire Race of *Plantagenet*.

Edward the Fourth soon fell, by his natural Intemperance, or rather by the insatiable Cruelty of *Gloucester*; who had already sacrificed his Brother *Clarence*, to pave his Way to the Throne. [pg 037] Nor better fared it with *Edward* the Fifth, who, by all the Arts of Seduction and Delusion, which his unnatural Uncle and Guardian, *Richard*, practised on the Fears and Weakness of the Queen Dowager; was, with his Brother the Duke of *York*, conveyed with great Pomp to the Tower; where the bloody Tyrant, aided by the Duke of *Buckingham*, soon sacrificed those young, innocent and hopeful Princes to his wicked and boundless Ambition. But he soon after lost his own flagitious Life, and a most cruelly-acquired Crown, on the Plains of *Bosworth*.

To him succeeded *Henry* the Seventh, and the first of the Race of *Tudor*, a great, wise and valiant Prince, but rather too much inclined to Rigour, and Avarice; Imperfections which extremely blemished his other great Qualities.

In the tenth Year of this Reign, the Parliamentary Constitution of *Ireland* received a deeper Stab than had ever before, or since, been inflicted thereon, by a Statute Law, commonly called *Poynin's Act*; by which a new, and, till that wretched Period, an unheard of Order, was added to the three established Ranks of the State. By this Law, the *English* Privy-Council may impose a *Negative* on the *free* and *unanimous* Parliamentary Ordinances of the representative Body of the Kingdom of *Ireland*; a manifest Injury to the Authority and Dignity of Parliament; and an equal Diminution of the Royal Prerogative, that only should include, and should alone exert, a Power so important.

In Times dark, tumultuated and dangerous, no Wonder extraordinary Laws should pass: *Desperate Diseases* require *desperate Remedies*: But when the *Fever* is removed, it certainly is a [pg 038] horrid Management to leave the blistering Plaister *still sticking* to the *recovered* Patient's Back.

The Distempers of this Nation were heavy, complicated and chronic; and finally curable, only by the salutary all-healing Hands of our present King, and present Parliament.

To *Henry* the Seventh succeeded *Henry* the Eighth, as consummate a Tyrant, in every Sense, as ever swayed the *British*, or any other Sceptre; whose whole Life was so continued a Scene of wanton Dissipation, Lust, Cruelty, Rapine, Bloodshed and Sacrilege, that it must have been a peculiar Happiness, to any Part of his Dominions, to have been *neglected* or *forgotten* by him: Nor could the two succeeding Reigns of *Edward* the Sixth, and Queen *Mary*, short, various, cloudy, and vastly agitated on the Score of Religion, (which, in those two Reigns, took Faces almost diametrically opposite,) afford this Kingdom much reflected Sunshine.

To those ensued that of Queen *Elizabeth*, a Princess of powerful Abilities, who, truly intent on the Peace and Welfare of her Subjects, caused her Laws to operate, and Justice to circulate in this Kingdom, abandoned, as hath been observed, to a State almost of Anarchy, thro' a dismal Series of seventeen Reigns: But the Reformation in Religion, which she established in *England*, and introduced in *Ireland*, much obviated her Purposes for the latter Kingdom: For, the *Irish*, more tenacious of their Altars, than of their Fire-places, could not easily reconcile themselves to the Exchange of a Religion they deemed a *new one*, for *that* they had been in Possession of from the fourth, to [pg 039] the fifteenth Century: Which produced a rebellious Defection, in a few of the principal Chieftains of this Land, and gave Occasion to the greedy Provincial Precedents, of trumping up *imaginary Rebellions*, to pave the Way to *real Forfeitures*; thereby to aggrandize their own Houses; what some of them effectually accomplished, to the Ruin and Extirpation of many honest Families.

This great and illustrious Princess, (whose Reign had remained untarnished, had it not been for the Death of the ill-fated Queen of *Scotland*) was succeeded by *James* the Sixth of *Scotland*, and the first of the *Stuart* Race that governed *England*: From this Prince, descended of *Irish* Kings, the People of *Ireland* might have expected many Favours and Immunities; wherein, however, they were miserably disappointed: Which, with a Train of other Hardships and antiparental Severities, (particularly his alienating, at *one Stroke*, six of the best Counties in the Kingdom, on the *procured* Testimony of an obscure wretched Individual, one *Teige Lenane*,) is too sufficient and too lasting a Proof of: *Heu! tot Conquesta Annorum, hauserit una Dies!* The Possession of at least twenty Centuries, of the great and

good, the heroic and hospitable *O Neils, O Donnels, Mac Guires, Mac Gennises, O Reillys, O Cahanes, &c.* ravished away to gratify hungry Favourites, and indigent Relatives! the six Counties, however, as the Law Term has it, *escheated*. Had the *Highlands of Scotland*, at that unhappy Period, been more populated, probably six or eight Counties *more* had been procured to *escheat*, and there had been a *braa Clutch of bonny Traitors*; the *O Connors, Mac Carthys, O Briens, O Donnels, O Hares, [pg 040] O Malones, &c.* had been *all* in the *same Bottom* with the Families above mentioned; especially, as they could not, according to *James the First's* own Phrase, *look to the Pope, and row with him*.

To *James the 6th of Scotland*, and first of *England*, succeeded *Charles the First*; who, notwithstanding his eminent Possession of all the Virtues that adorn and illustrate human Nature, could neither divert the adverse Fate of Subjects, or prevent his own.

The Disseisin of many honest Families in the County of *Kilkenny*, and elsewhere, by the Earl of *Strafford*, on stale Pretences of *Non Performance of Covenants* on their Part; his Attempt of confiscating twenty-five Parts in thirty of the whole Province of *Connaught*, on a Claim of Descent, dormant 300 Years, and *originally ill founded*, with the arbitrary Steps by him taken to the Accomplishment of this wasteful Purpose; too clearly proved that Nobleman a second *Verres*. The cruel and intoxicated Administration of the Rump Parliament; the insolent, licentious, and riotous Controul of the military *Independents*; the abject Tyranny of *Oliver Cromwell*, who prostrated Constitution, Church and State, will always be recollected with the Contempt, Horror, and Detestation of every good Subject.

The Calamities from 1641, to the happy Restoration of King *Charles the Second*, in 1660, being common to all good Subjects, were the more tolerable, *ferre quam sortem patiuntur omnes, nemo recusat*: But now or never, surely, might his ever loyal, ever faithful *Irish* Subjects have, with the most reasonable Assurance, hoped, if not for publick and lasting Rewards, the common [pg 041] Wages of uncommon Fidelity; at least, for a Restitution of what had been their own, through Ages immemorial.

Will late Posterity *believe*, that, in Favour of mercenary Adventurers, who advanced Money to provide for a desperate regicide Army; in Favour of the

Officers of this same Army, whom their Ringleader *Cromwell*, seared as his Conscience was, indulged with no more than *temporary* Grants of the Estates belonging to the King's most faithful Subjects: Will Posterity, I say, believe, that, in special Favour of such Men, those *identical Subjects*, the bravest Advocates, as well as the most affectionate undeviating Friends of the Monarchy and Constitution, were *for ever* deprived of their Properties! To remunerate the *others*, the most *inveterate* and *implacable* Enemies of EITHER! *Doing Good for Evil* is a Divine Precept, and certainly includes a most sublime Moral; but *rendering Evil for Good*, is such a Principle as must carry Horror with it, among savage Nations!

The King of *France's* immediate Letter, on this Subject, to King *Charles* the Second, as it reflects Honour on the Memory of those illustrious Sufferers, I therefore take Leave to transcribe in this Place.

* * * * *

His Most Christian Majesty's Letter to the King of Great Britain, in Favour of the Roman Catholicks of Ireland.

“Most High, Most Excellent, and Most Potent Prince, our dear and well-beloved Brother and Cousin! At the same Time that we have been told of your Majesty's great Goodness towards your Subjects, and the Precedent [pg 042] you have given of an extraordinary Clemency, in granting them your general Amnesty (some few only excepted, of those whom the Blood of their King, and that of his People, cry aloud to Heaven for Revenge against). We could not but let your Majesty know, that we were extremely surprized to hear, that the *Catholicks of Ireland* were *excluded* from that Act of Oblivion, and, by that Means, put into the Number of the *most criminal*! This News has so much the more excited our Compassion towards them, that we have been informed, that, in *all the Changes* which have hitherto happened in your Dominions, and in the almost general *Defection of* your Subjects, *none* stood *more constant* to their lawful Sovereign, even in the greatest Streights, than the *Catholicks*: So that, if they are now branded for their Religion, it may be said, for their Honour, that, in Times past, none could be found *readier*, or

more *cheerfully disposed*, than *they*, to serve and assist their Prince; and that with so much *Ardour*, that their Zeal then for the Royal Family was reckoned a certain Mark of their true Religion. It is for that Reason that we now become their Intercessors to you: For, otherwise, had they *failed* in the Fidelity they owe you, instead of interceding for them, we would join with you in using them with all imaginable Rigour; and it would never come into our Thoughts to concern ourselves, as we do, for the *Catholicks of Ireland*; though we *were obliged to it*, by the last Treaty of Peace made with the Marquess of *Ormond*, and which was granted them by our Mediation. And, as we are well assured, [pg 043] that, since the Conclusion of that Peace, they have done Nothing which can be called a *Failure of their Duty to you*, we find ourselves under so much the greater Obligation to conjure you, to make good that Treaty to them, in that they *religiously* observed it on *their* Side, in all its Parts: And to beseech you not to suffer, that either the Hatred, which an immoderate Zeal swells some bigotted Sectaries with, nor the unlucky Spoils of these poor People, render criminal or miserable the *most faithful* of your Subjects; to whom their lawful King, as you are, is not *the less dear*, nor *less respected*, because of a *different Belief* from *theirs*. We propose Nothing to ourselves in this, nor ask any Thing, but what we daily *practise* (as you may know) towards those of our Subjects who are of the *reformed Religion*. And, as we have commanded the Sieur Marquis *de Rouvigny* to explain our Sentiments more amply on this Subject to you, be pleased to give him a favourable Audience: And, above all Things, be perswaded, that, in this Affair, we have no less your own *true Interest* in View, than what *natural Reason* and *Equity* requires; and that our sincere Friendship for you is the principal Motive of this Request. Dated at *Paris*, the 7th of *September*, 1660.”

The *good King Charles*, regardless of this important Solicitation, unattentive to the plain Suggestions of *common Right*, and unaccountably forgetful of all their *past signal Services* and inviolate Zeal; observed indeed that those faithful *Irish* Subjects had no Stock; consequently, that dispossessing the Adherents of *Oliver*, who, with [pg 044] the Land, had pirated the national Stock, would cause much Confusion. As for the *former*, he hoped some Settlement might in Time be found for them; (in Truth, I believe, for aught his Majesty in Reality concerned himself, this might have been in *Terra Australis Incognita*). Their Want of Stock is the less to be

admired at, it being well known, that, with their Pay in foreign Service, chiefly expended to contribute all in their Power to the *Royal Support*, they even went so far as to sell their Plate, and valuable Moveables, to answer the same *generous Purpose*: But, when every known Acre in the Kingdom, that could be disposed of, was given away by Wholesale to the Duke of *York*, the Heir-apparent of the Crown, (partial Distribution!) to new-fangled Favourites, and the staunch old Enemies of Church and Crown; it was hoped some Lands might be yet discovered, to satisfy and compensate those *Irish* Worthies, who had Nothing left for their Support, beside an inalienable Sense of Honour and Loyalty, and a Character of invincible Fidelity (which all Nations admired and applauded). No such Discovery, however, was made, nor any relative to the *Irish*, under that Administration, but what tended to convince them, by the famous Act of Settlement, &c. of the extraordinary severe Peculiarity of their Fate! Yet, ordained to shew Posterity unprecedented Specimens of Loyalty and Zeal, they still adhered, with inflexible Constancy, to the Fortunes of King *James* the Second, not mindful of their Injuries by *James* the First, their unexampled Sufferings by the excessive harsh Measures of King *Charles* the First, his Ministers, and Deputies, or their unheard-of Treatment (I won't say *Wrongs*, it [pg 045] being a Maxim the King of *England* can do none) by King *Charles* II. Little Wonder, a House, constantly sapping it's own best Pillars, should at length fall.

King *James* the Second, constrained to abdicate the Throne of *England*, endeavoured the Preservation of this his Kingdom of *Ireland*, where his faithful Subjects, (a Remnant of the various and manifold Wastes of foregoing Reigns) considering the thousand Disadvantages they laboured under, made *such a Stand* as later Ages will look up to with Astonishment! A Parcel of Men, congregated in the utmost Hurry and Confusion, undisciplin'd, unarm'd, unclothed, unpaid! Yet did those very Men, animated by the Example of their heroick Leaders, (I mean their immediate Lords and Countrymen) on the Plains of *Aughrim*, convince the best veteran Army that Day in *Europe*, superior in Numbers, excellently provided for in every Respect, and conducted by a Prince of singular Valour and Address, that *Irishmen* were deserving of more auspicious Stars.

Never was a more gallant Defence than they, after this, made in *Limerick*; where, although abandoned by the Prince, (whose Cause they had so remarkably espoused) and his auxiliary *French*, they obtained an honourable CAPITULATION from those in Commission under King *William* the Third, whose strict *Observance* thereof, to the End of his glorious Life, reflects, among many other his great Atchievements, deserved Honour on his Memory.

The distinguished Figure made by those Noblemen and Gentlemen, who, regardless of *Property* or *Ease*, followed the Destiny of that hard-fated Prince, King *James* the Second, [pg 046] (namely, the Lords *Mount-Cashel*, *Tyrconnel*, *Clare* and *Lucan*, the *Dillons*, *Nugents*, *Rooths*, *Burkes*, *Lees*, *Fitz-Geralds*, *Cooks*, *Lacys*, *Browns*, *Wogans*, *Baggots*, *Sheridans*, *Creaghs*, *Plunkets*, *Barnewals*, *Neagles*, *Lallys*, *Mac Carthys*, *Mac Donnels*, *Mac Guires*, *Mac Namarras*, *Mac Mahons*, *Mac Gennis's*, *O Neils*, *O Connors*, *O Donnels*, *O Briens*, *O Dwyers*, *O Shaghnessys*, *O Mahonys*, *O Sullivans*, *O Kellys*, *O Ferralls*, *O Reillys*, *O Haras*, *O Hogans*, *O Byrnes*, *O Daes*, &c. &c. &c. the military Annals of *Germany*, *France*, *Spain*, *Flanders*, *Italy*, *Naples*, and *Russia*), must bear ample and authentic Testimony of, to future Ages.

Those were they, of whom Dr. *Mac en Crow* gives the following concise, but just and happy Character.

*Genus acre Bello, Studiis Genus acre Minervæ, Devotumque mori pro Rege,
Fidêque tuendis.*

Among those who followed the Fortunes of King *James* the Second, were Sir *Richard Neagle*, his Attorney-General, and Dr. *Moore*, Provost of *Trinity-college*, near *Dublin*; two Gentlemen very justly distinguished in their respective Spheres; the former, a Gentleman of unshaken Integrity, and great Capacity in the Profession of the Laws; the latter, of exemplary Piety, universal Learning, and fine Accomplishments. *Louis* the Fourteenth, then King of *France*, protected those worthy deserving Men, with singular Tenderness and Attention; and was instructed and guided solely by Dr. *Moore*, in the restoring, establishing, and modelling the University of *Paris*,

at that gloomy Period! quite buried in perplexed, unintelligible, peripatetic [pg 047] Philosophy, and disfigured with romantic Legends, and Gothic Jingle! But, at the Doctor's Appearance, Entities, Quiddities, Sympathies, Antipathies, occult Qualities, substantial Forms, metaphysical Degrees, Categories, and all this unideal wordy Stuff, vanished; and were succeeded by a clear, concise Method of Reasoning, and sound, useful, and experimental Philosophy. *Greek, Hebrew, Syriac, Chaldaic, and Arabic*, were Languages *untaught, unknown*, in the University of *Paris*, before Dr. *Moore*; for whom particularly, *Louis* the Fourteenth founded, established, and endowed the Royal College, now called *College du Cambray*: And how well our Doctor succeeded therein, may be inferred from the Character and Writings of his Pupils and Hearers, *Boileau, Fontinelle, Poréc, Montesquieu, Fleuri, Lauguet*, with many others, and *Rollin*, his peculiar Favourite and immediate Successor, *all* great Genius's, applauded Writers, and celebrated Wits. So that, as *Ireland* had the Honour of founding, it had also that of restoring and reviving the great University of *Paris*, in the Persons of two of its learned Natives.

The Reign of her Majesty Queen *Anne* (glorious to her Arms, under the Conduct of *John*, Duke of *Marlborough*, and her other Generals, and justly distinguished by the Number of great Genius's and Wits, who enlightened that Period) was in this Kingdom chiefly employed in *additional* Acts against the further Growth of Popery: And many there were, who deemed it an unparallel'd Severity in her Majesty, to give her Royal Assent to them particular Laws; by which the *Roman Catholicks* of *Ireland* (already ruined by their inimitable Allegiance to her [pg 048] Royal Father, Uncle, and Grandfather) were *precluded* from availing themselves, by a tolerable easy Lease, of any Part or Parcel of these Estates, forfeited by their Ancestors, thro' their unremitting Endeavours, to support and maintain that Stem, of which she was herself an immediate Branch.

So late even as this Reign, the whole Kingdom of *Ireland* was a desolate diffusive Scene of total Decay! covered with all the ghastly Symptoms of the Consumption of Centuries! But, at length, on the happy Accession of his late Majesty of glorious Memory, the blissful Morning of Peace and Concord began its auspicious Dawn! Yet, as Time, publick Spirit, Patriotism (in its highest Conception) and unwearied Diligence, were all collectively

essential to the giving Life, Vigour, and Activity, to national Industry and Improvement, so very long in a melancholy State of Languor and Oppression: Not before the present truly glorious Reign, did *Hibernia* tune her old Harp, now newly strung to universal Harmony and Elegance, and rear her awful Head from the stupid dismal Dozes of Ages; where comes the literal Application of my third Motto, RENASCIMUR.

*Hinc priscae redeunt Artes, felicibus inde Ingeniis aperitur iter, despectaque
Musæ Colla levant.*—

Having travelled through a tedious Night, thick-set with Horrors of various Hues! and thus come to the End of a painful Journey; give me Leave, kind Reader, to indulge awhile with admiring the beautiful Variety of Objects, which now surround me, to the serene Delight [pg 049] of the Mind, and refined Gratification of Sense; before I attempt that Display of them to which I have no Occasion of professing my Inequality.

In this Reign, and not before, our Linen Manufacture, in many Respects one of the most profitable Branches of our national Commerce, received all the Encouragement from Royal Bounty, and Parliamentary Sanction, that could be reasonably hoped for.

Persons of the highest Rank, Dignity, and Fortune, were appointed *Trustees* for the Propagation, Encouragement, and Diffusion, of this beneficial Trade, throughout the respective Provinces.

The *Linen-Hall* was erected in *Dublin*, under as just and nice Regulations as any commercial House in *Europe*.

The North of *Ireland* began to wear an Aspect entirely new; and, from being (through Want of Industry, Business, and Tillage) the almost exhausted Nursery of our *American* Plantations, soon became a populous Scene of Improvement, Traffic, Wealth, and Plenty; and is, at this Day, a well-planted District, considerable for Numbers of well-affected, useful, and industrious Subjects.

Now arose, now shone forth, the ever Honourable DUBLIN SOCIETY; a Society equalled by none. It is true, we read of Patriarchs, Philosophers, Warriors, Orators, and Poets; of Senates, Parliaments, Councils, &c. but we no where, abstracted from our own Country, meet a Set of pious Patriots, from their *private Funds*, adorning their Country in general, in every Degree and Branch of Industry, and Improvement; and, inspired with Sentiments truly public and social, munificently rewarding their [pg 050] Countrymen, of whatsoever Denomination, without Favour or Distinction; for meliorating their proper Estates, or Farms; for excelling in any Production of Nature, or Art; for any Discovery, or Invention, useful to Mankind: A Set of *truly honourable*, and *generous* Personages, instructing their Countrymen with clear, yet philosophical Precepts, encouraging them by their Example, and rewarding them from their inexhaustible Bounty! *Such*, and *such unrivalled*, is the ILLUSTRIOUS DUBLIN SOCIETY! What Pity, the ample Distributions, and instructive Writings of this learned and munificent Body, are not regularly published, in *Latin, English, and French*, for the peculiar Honour of this Nation, the Edification of Posterity, and as a bright Pattern of Imitation to all other civiliz'd Countries!

Now likewise appeared the *Philharmonic Society*, that, (from a few Gentlemen, who used *occasionally* to meet, in order to while away an Hour with a gentle Tune, and chearful Glass) grew into an harmonious Body, not alone for the Improvement of the charming Art of Music, but for the *effectual Relief* also of successive Thousands, from Misery, Famine, and Confinement: *Concordiâ res parvæ crescunt*. ORPHEUS, we are told, built the Walls of *Thebes*, by the irresistible Powers of Harmony: Be this true or fabulous; how many Iron Gates have we not seen open, to the persuasive Charities of this tuneful Society! how many gloomy Cells vacated by their Charms! This elegant Society, by moderate Loans, Interest-free to the industrious Poor, prevents many such from getting into the Distress of Prisons, or following offensive Courses; and, by enabling them to obtain [pg 051] an honest Livelihood, rendereth them useful Members to the Community: So that, of this Society, it might have been justly said,

Omne tulit Punctum quæ miscuit utile dulci.

In this happy Reign was incorporated, under the protective Sanction of Royal Bounty, a Society, truly Christian, for the pious Establishment of *Protestant* CHARTER-SCHOOLS throughout the Kingdom: An Institution far more productive of national Morality, and Reformation, than excommunicative Discipline, or restrictive penal Statutes; since Persuasion and Rewards have ever been, and must ever continue to be, more consistent with the meek and benevolent Temper of true Christianity, more effectual, Apostolic, and Catholic, than *Punishments, Persecution, or Sequestrations.*

In this Reign shines out a Christian Divine, who, in the inestimable individual Dr. *Madden*, collects *a whole Society of Patriots*; a venerable Man, not alone the Guide of his particular Congregation, but a pure, also clear and lasting Light of Perfection, and noble Imitation, to his Countrymen in general.

On *Madden*, kindred Angels smile!
Bright Mirrour to his native Isle!
To whom old Age shall say, and Youth,
With grateful and prophetic Truth,

Semper Honos, Nomenq; tuum, Laudesq; manebunt.

St. *Patrick's* Hospital, for the Reception of Lunaticks and Ideots, a lasting Monument of the late Dean *Swift's* Charity, as are his various [pg 052] Writings, of his great Genius and Wit: *Mercer's* charitable Hospitable in *Stephen-street*: The noble Hospital for the Relief of poor Lying-inn-Women, of the Projection of our late excellent Countryman, Dr. *Bartholomew Mosse*; by which a great Number of Women and Children are preserved from miserable and untimely Ends: The *Charitable Infirmary* on the *Inns-Quay*: The New Hospital for *Incurables*, on *Lazer's-Hill*: St. *Nicholas's* Hospital, in *Francis-street*: The *Meath* Hospital, in *Skinner's Alley*: The *Lock* Hospital, in *George's-Lane*, for hapless Women and Children, tainted with the Venereal Infection: And the Charitable Hospital in *King-street, Oxmantown*, are all the humane and pious Growth of this transcendent Reign.

Those Hospitals are duly and regularly attended, by the most eminent Physicians, and skilful Surgeons, without Fee or Reward: So that, from this

obvious Consideration, the frequent and large Collections in our Churches, for the comfortable Support, and Christian Education, of indigent Boys; the stated Distributions of our Chief Magistrates, to the Helpless and Needy; and, in Truth, from the general Disposition of its worthy Inhabitants; we may, without any Risque of incurring the least Censure of Adulation, or Vanity, pronounce DUBLIN as charitable a Metropolis as any in the known World. In the beautiful new Garden, plann'd by Dr. Mosse, breathing in all the natural Fragrance of the Spring, adorned with all the Elegancies of Art, all the Splendor of Illumination, and inspired with the most soothing Charms of delightful Harmony; to behold Crowds of young Ladies, in the full Glow of Beauty, and Bloom of Youth, finely habited, [pg 053] and elegantly decorated in the Manufactures of our own Country, (and finished in the most exquisite Taste, by our own Artizans); to behold them, I say, converting their very Amusements and Recreations to the heavenly Purposes of relieving the Distressed, must, to every thinking *Irish* Spectator, afford a Prospect of the utmost rational Joy!

As all Men, who render their Country distinguished Honour, or singular Service, deserve, therefore, lasting Monuments of public grateful Acknowledgment to their Memories; it is hoped that, in this Respect, Dr. Mosse will not be forgotten by those who are evidently fond of encouraging and rewarding public Zeal:

Eternal Joys to Mosse kind Heaven give,
By whom, on Earth, so many Thousands live!

The *Marine Society*, of recent Institution also, disposeth many poor young Men into a Condition of acquiring an honest, and praise-worthy Livelihood, and of becoming useful Members of the Community; by serving on Board of his Majesty's Fleets in War-time, and serving our Merchants in Times of Peace; and, in this double Capacity, of contributing to the general Welfare of their Mother-Country, to which they may otherwise prove a Burden.

Our publick Entertainments of various Kinds are, for the most Part, conducted with strict Propriety, and real Politeness; those especially of the Theatre, which should, by no Means, pass for Matter of slight or casual Consideration; seeing the *Romans*, the greatest of all People, esteemed the Theatre worthy the Attention of particular Laws, *Roscia Lex Theatralis*, &c.

Mr. [pg 054] *Sheridan's* general Merit as a *Player* stands confessed; but as a *Manager*, that Gentleman's falling frequently under the heavy Displeasure of the Public, (whether from an haughty Distaste to his Profession, or indulged Arrogance of Temper) with his violent Introduction of anti-dramatick Rope and Wire-dancing, Tumbling, and Fire-eating, to the visible Degradation of a liberal Stage, whereon nothing mean, shocking, or monstrous, should ever appear; he hath not succeeded so well: Then, his Scheme of uniting an Academy, for the sober regular Education of Youth, with a publick Theatre, seemed rather the feverish Delusion of a distempered Brain, and heated Imagination, than the cool deliberate Result of rational Judgment; from which fermented Source, also seem'd directly to flow his avowed Concern for the *long lost Art of Oratory* among us: Had Mr. *Sheridan* attended to the Debates of our High Court of Parliament; been frequent in our different Churches, and at the Bars of our Courts of Judicature; and had, in this Case, formed a comparative Judgment, from the Writings of *Demosthenes*, *Plato*, *Isocrates*, *Cicero*, and *Pliny* the Younger; from the Rules and Precepts of *Aristotle*, *Longinus*, *Horace*, *Quintilian*, *Scaliger*, *Rapin*, *Porée*, and *Rollin*; he had been *then* convinced how little Occasion there was for his *lamenting* the *Loss* of an Art in this Kingdom, which breathes there in full Maturity of all it's persuasive Charms. This his dogmatical Assertion of the *long-lost Art of Oratory*, his wild *Academical* Projects, with the foregoing theatrical Inconsistencies, too much subject that Gentleman to the Character given, by the *Roman* Satirist, of an assuming sharp-set *Greekling*:

[pg 055]

*Gramaticus, Rhetor, Geometres, Pictor, Aliptes, Augur, Scænobates, Medicus,
Magus, omnia novit.*

Upon the Whole, I will readily grant Mr. *Sheridan* a *Roscius*, if the Name can sooth him; a *Critic*; nay, an *Orator*; but I shall be bold to assert, that we have many, very many, in this Kingdom, of far greater Powers than that Gentleman, whereof some of his Orations, *so called*, are incontrovertible Testimonies.

This Kingdom hath of late Years exhibited as justly celebrated Male and Female Players, as any other; evinced in the Characters of Messieurs *Quin, Ryan, Delane, Sheridan, Barry, Mossop, Dexter, Sparks*, Mrs. *Woffington*, the inimitable Mrs. *Fitz-Henry*, and several others, of either Sex.

Mr. *Barry's* Capacity, as a Manager, appeareth equal to his eminently-affecting Powers in Tragedy, (so generally known, and so unexceptionably confessed) from the magnificent Theatre, erected by that Gentleman, with amazing Expedition, in Grandeur, Convenience, and Elegance, preferable to any in *London*, or *Paris*: From the obliging Decency the respective Performances thereof are conducted with, and evidently from the surpassing theatrical Abilities of the Company, that, with the most engaging Variety, entertains the Publick in *Crow-street* Play-house. I have sometimes seen, and have been as often delighted, with Performances of the Gentlemen just mentioned, as with those of the admired Mr. *Garrick*, and the famous Messieurs *Dufrésne, Gossin, and Quinault*; and, if I may take Leave to declare my Opinion, am therein clear that Mr. *Barry*, in the exquisitely [pg 056] pathetick Strokes of deep Tragedy, touches the Soul with as much delicate Sensibility, and, in the irrefrainable Sallies of the more boisterous Passions, soars with as majestick Wings, as any one of them, I will not say higher. To behold Mr. *Barry*, sublimely struggling in a Storm of Adversity, with the sudden Shocks, and unexpected Blows of Fortune; *then*, (when all human Efforts must yield to inevitable Necessity) sinking in the irretrievable Plunge of Sorrow and Calamities, with that calm Resignation ever attendant on true Heroism; must convince any judicious Spectator of his being born a Tragedian. I must here declare, that what I have advanced on this Subject neither ariseth from Prepossession on one Side, or Prejudice on the other; having no Manner of Connection, nay, not even a personal Acquaintance, with Mr. *Barry*; nor any Objection to Mr. *Sheridan*, but such as must naturally issue from my just Resentment against any Individual, of whatsoever Rank, Character, or Denomination, who should prove so ignorant, and yet so hardy, as to declare *Elocution lost* in our native Country; an illiberal Censure, which, if true, had necessarily wrapped our High Court of Parliament, the whole Body of our Clergy, our University, Bench and Bar, in Shades that, I am certain, had been never dispell'd by the Approach of Light, so dim and glimmering as that Gentleman's.

Let us now take a summary View of the Inhabitants of *Ireland*, in their respective Ranks: And to begin with the Peers: Are they not such Personages, as, by their Munificence, Affability of Manners, Easiness of Comportment, Propriety of Appearance, and Generosity in dealing, reflect true Honour on Nobility; and, [pg 057] Reality, derive their superior Rank, as much from the Pre-eminence of their Virtues, as from the constitutional Dignity of their Titles?

The Encrease of our People, Wealth, Commerce, Industry, Arts, Inventions; the extraordinary additional Number, in this happy Reign, of our beautiful Seats, elegant Improvements, useful and ornamental Plantations, extensive Inclosures, excellent high Roads, (formerly almost impassable,) with the visible Reformation in national Harmony, and Allegiance, will best suggest an Idea of the Honourable the House of Commons of *Ireland*, composed of such candid Spirits, as, neither the Smiles or Frowns of superior Influence, popular Views, or private Connections, can bend from the various essential Duties due to their King, their Country, and themselves; constant in their Attendance; careful in their Protection; and zealous in their Promotion of publick Felicity; not more extensive in their noble Projects, for this great Purpose, than expeditious in carrying those into Execution.

Our Constitution, partly of *Gothic*, partly of *Norman* Institution, (the first High Court of Parliament on the present Establishment, having been ordained in the Reign of *Henry* the First, Son of *William* the Conqueror) avoiding the turbulent Licentiousness of a *Democracy*, the factious domineering Temper of *Aristocracy*, and the variable oppressive Sway of *Arbitrary Monarchy*; but including, by an harmonious Assemblage, the essential Virtues of those different Systems of Government; is unquestionably the *best digested* and *wisest* in the known World: Under which, the King and the Nobles, with the Commons, *unite*, to extend the Commerce, [pg 058] promote the Happiness, guard over the Safety, preserve the Lives, defend the Characters, support the Liberties, and protect the Property of the People. Bless'd Constitution! O! may it ever flourish! under whose mild and preservative Influence, a few only feel Restraint; except from the Commission of private Evil, or social Injury.

I have said a *Few only*; because there are some among us, who, on the Score of Religion, are secluded from permanent Property: And even Those, it is hoped, will, in Consideration of the invariable Tenor of their humble and pacific Conduct, from the Capitulation of *Limerick*, to this Day; and from their unanimous and chearful Obedience to our Civil Government, e're long obtain some Mitigation of their Affairs; such the benevolent Temper and Disposition of the present incomparable Reign! Some late excellent³ Pamphlets, wherein these Gentlemen's political Principles are fully and clearly explained, shew of what signal Advantage it had been to the Numbers, Industry, Health, Wealth, and Beauty of this Kingdom, to indulge them a Property, even in our uncultivated Mountains, dreary Wastes, and noxious Marshes: Which Measure, should it appear in a true Light to our worthy Representatives, we may in a few Years more, hope to see *Ireland* one of the most beautiful, best-improved, best-conditioned Islands in the Universe. Our Bench is adorned with Honourable Personages, conspicuous for Learning, Integrity, Humanity, and Impartiality; [pg 059] of whom, it may be boldly affirmed, and with the strictest Truth, that they are not Favourers of Persons. The present Lord Chief Justice of the *King-Bench*, the late Master of the Rolls, and Chancellor of the Exchequer, Natives of *Ireland*, formed a Triumvirate, whose Learning, Worth, and distinguished Abilities, had rendered them eminently respectable in the brightest *Æras*, either of the *Roman* Commonwealth, or Empire.

Our Attorney and Solicitor General, our Serjeants at Law, and King's Council, with many eminent Barristers, and a Set of learned eloquent young Gentlemen, all shining out together; such as *Tully*, *Hortensius*, and *Pliny*, had with fond Tenderness cherished and with pleasing Pride, avowed for their Pupils; form as distinguished a Body of Advocates and Orators, as adorn any Courts of Judicature in *Europe*.

In the Diocese of *Dublin* existeth a truly pious Society for the Relief and Support of the Widows and Children of the inferior Clergy thereof. It is, indeed, surprizing in a Kingdom, such (thank Heaven) as *Ireland* is, that the Example of this charitable Society, hath not been *universally* followed. It hath often affected me to the Quick, to have seen a learned Divine, after a tedious and painful Free-School Institution, and expensive University Education, struggling, upon a poor Pension or Salary of *Forty* Pounds a

Year, to maintain an honest Gentlewoman, Children, and Servants, (and really with some Decency of Hospitality) sedulously discharging, at the same Time, the different Duties of the pastoral Function; when a *foreign Fidler* shall run away with tripple that Sum, or more, for one Night's Performance. [pg 060] I would by no Means be understood to derogate from the Merits of fine Performers in the different Parts of Musick, or endeavour to diminish their reasonable Perquisites: But, surely, such Men and such Things are not to be thought of, in Competition with those, who, by Teaching and Preaching, refine our Morals, instruct our Understandings, inform our Lives, and enlighten our Souls with the celestial Spirit of the Christian Faith; and thereby happily lead us, through this transient and precarious State, to eternal Tranquilly and Bliss. I am not a Preacher; but thus far shall venture: As the Fear of the Lord is the Beginning of Wisdom, our generally following the heavenly Example of this venerable Society, must be a great Test as well of the one, as the other. If the Bishops, the temporal Lords, and great estated Men of each Diocese, would but graciously lead the Way, it is not unlikely they had been attended by Crowds of zealous Followers: And, in Fact, a *small Matter annually set apart*, from even the superfluous Outgoings of the Wealthy and Opulent, of different Ranks, would very happily answer the generous noble End of preserving, from an anxious State of particular Dependance, Numbers of virtuous, well-educated Gentlewomen, and their Children, from the various Miseries, which the untimely Death of a Father, and narrow Circumstances, but too frequently expose them to; an End so every Way worthy the natural Disposition, the benevolent Temper, the inherent Hospitality, and the essentially-charitable Character of *Ireland*.

Our *Protestant* Brethren, the *Dissenters*, by a prudent and pious Regulation of secreting one Pound a Year, each parochial Minister, for this [pg 061] religiously humane Purpose, have constantly a Fund sufficient to allow the Relict of each Clergyman twenty Pounds a Year, (which preserves her from the Miseries of Want and Dependance) and have, at some Periods, wherewith to set their Children up, in an honest and creditable Way of living. As we are emulously fond of adopting the Wisdom and Virtues of each Christian Sect and Society, it is fervently hoped we will also this tender and pious Scheme; a Scheme so comprehensive of true Charity, and so productive of social and happy Effects! How difficult is it for Minds,

crowded with Cares, and beset with the pressing Calls of Family-preservation, to attend, with due Composure and Inclination, to the various indispensable Duties of the pastoral Office? But how chearfully would those Reverend Gentlemen proceed in their divine Mission, when, by some visible Provision for the proper Objects of their present Cares and future Concern, they should, in a great Measure, be released from domestick Anxiety, from gloomy Apprehensions, and alarming Prospects, into the temporal Futurity of those, for whom they must be necessarily affected with the most tender Feelings!

The most convincing and decisive Method of adjudging Causes, being by a comprehensive View and critical Examination of their Effects; of Streams, by a nice Scrutiny and Investigation of their Sources; hence may we, from the shining Characters, and extensive Abilities of our Divines and Barristers, frame a just Idea of the University of *Dublin*, which, for Compass and Extent of the Sciences, Variety of elegant Arts, found Erudition, and polite Literature therein taught, in the most regular and perspicuous [pg 062] Methods, is equalled by few, excelled by none.

The Students are carefully instructed in the more refined Parts of classical Learning; oriental, antient, and modern Languages; Criticism, sacred and profane History, Oratory, Logick, Ethicks, and Metaphysicks; in natural and experimental Philosophy; Anatomy, Botany and Chymistry; the mathematicks, in Theory and Practice; Civil and Canon Laws; Theology, Controversy, and Ecclesiastical History: So that, with a good Capacity, and regular Application, one may depart this University, as completely and happily instituted for the honorary Professions of Life, as may be reasonably expected from any Nursery of Learning extant. The obtaining a Fellowship in this University, is a demonstrative Test of comprehensive native Talents, thorough intellectual Cultivation, deep and various learned Acquirements.

The *Newtonian* Philosophy, the excellent *Boyle's* experimental Philosophy, and Mr. *Locke's* Metaphysicks, prevail much in the College of *Dublin*: Which, for Extent, Convenience, Magnificence, and a most sumptuous elegant Library, exceeds any one College in *Europe*. The beautiful Parks belonging to it, seem actually, on a serene Evening, the delightful Vale of

Tempe, or enchanting Recesses of *Parnassus*, inhabited by all the Muses, all the Graces, with their charming Train.

The Trade of *Ireland*, however in former Times miserably restrained and limited, hath in this happy Reign received considerable Enlargements; such as, the opening several Wooll-Ports; the Bounty on *Irish* Linens, now our staple Commodity, imported into *Great-Britain*; [pg 063] and the Immunity lately granted of importing thither Beef, Butter, Tallow, Candles, Pork, Hides, live Cattle, &c. a Privilege that, in its Consequences, must prove of signal Advantage to both Nations; to *this* especially, as we shall hereby be enabled, upon any occasional Exigency, to supply our protecting Friends, and proportionably stint the Hands of our Enemies, who, (by the Profusion of Wines and spirituous Liquors, annually exported from *France* to Ireland, in Exchange for our Beef, Butter, &c. to pass over the Gluts of Teas and Spirits, &c. smuggled thence by the *western* Runners) have constantly the Balance on their Side. Our Exports, with those already mentioned, consist in a few Cheeses, Salmon and Kelp: But, as our Linens are, without Question, become the vital Spring of *Irish* Commerce, it is Matter of great Concern and equal Surprize, that the other Provinces do not more *universally* and *effectually* follow the lucrative Example of the *North*! since, it is evident, nothing but *equal Industry* can be wanting to render them *equally flourishing*, The Over-growth of Graziers and Stockmasters, is the strongest Indication that can be of national Waste and Decay, in respect of Inhabitants. What could a Foreigner, travelling among us, particularly in the *western* Counties, some Summers past, judge of our national Wisdom and Oeconomy? Would he not start even at our Humanity, on seeing the best arable Grounds in the Kingdom, in immense Tracts, wantonly enjoyed by the Cattle of a few petulant Individuals; and at the same Juncture, our high Ways and Streets crowded with Shoals of mendicant fellow-creatures! reduced, through Want of proper Sustenance, to the utmost Distress? [pg 064] Would not a *Frenchman* for Example, give a Shrug extraordinary, at finding, in every little Inn, *Bordeaux* Claret and *Nantz* Brandy, though, in all Likelihood, not a Morsel of *Irish* Bread?

It is much to be hoped, That, when the Spirit of Tillage should become more general and active, our Farmers more attentive to the Growth of the best Kinds of Grain, and our Brewers, more attentive to the Rules and Precepts

for that Purpose laid down by the Honourable the DUBLIN SOCIETY; we shall have little or no Occasion for that Inundation of *London Porter*; (an heavy, cloudy, intoxicating, ill-flavoured Liquor) that annually overflows this City and other Parts of the Kingdom; as, in the above Case, we may have a sufficient Plenty and Variety of Malt Liquors, our own native Produce, far better than any imported; and, in Case of a Redundancy of Grain, (a Matter not very likely to happen) may, with moderate Care, have Spirituous Liquors of far a more wholesome Nature, exquisite Taste, and delicate Flavour, than those imported at an extraordinary Expence; and but too often adulterated, in the first Concoction.

We have, in several Parts of this Kingdom, (in the Province of *Munster* especially) a recy, spirituous, fine-flavoured Cyder, very little, if at all, inferior to the best imported White Wines; and a moderate Plenty of grateful Honey-Liquors, which, with our prime Beef, Mutton, Pork, Veal, Lamb, Variety of Fowls, tame and wild; red and fallow Deer; Hares, Rabbits, Pidgeons, Pheasants, Grouse; and Partridge; wild Duck, Plover, Snipe, &c. Lake, River, Shell and Sea Fish, of all Kinds; [pg 065] the Produce of the Garden, (Horticulture having of late Years so vastly improved among us, that we now have many curious Plants, Fruits, and Flowers, not only not *known*, but never even *heard of*, in former Times) and *all* in such Plenty and Perfection, as demonstrate *Ireland* happier than most other Countries, in regard of the Necessaries and even of the Delicacies of Life; to which may be added, the great Number of our beautiful Lakes, noble Rivers, pure Fountains, limpid Streams, and Health-restoring mineral Wells.⁴ In this Country are bred valuable Horses, for the Draught, Road, and Chace; and for the Course, as high-formed ones, as in any Part of *Europe*; and large horned Cattle, and Sheep in Abundance.

It must afford real Satisfaction to consider the universal and visible Reformation in the Lives and Morals even of our common People, clearly evinced in this, that (thank Heaven) fewer legal Punishments succeed an entire Circuit, in our happy Days, than did a single Assize in former Reigns: And, without Question, this Reformation must still rise higher, in Proportion to the Lenity of our worthy Legislature, and wise Indulgence of our landed Men, who must certainly find it more conducive to the Welfare of the State, and to their own Strength, Honour, and Interest, to have their

Estates farmed and inhabited by a great Number of honest, laborious improving Families, than wasted by a few Purse-proud Bullock-Brokers, who rarely allow the wretched Herd of an hundred, as much Ground [pg 066] for his own and poor Family's Support, as is equal to that of two Bullocks.

Suppose a Gentleman was to let two thousand Acres of arable Ground to farm; were it not demonstrably more conducive to all the foregoing Motives, to dispose of these to twenty honest, industrious Families, at an hundred Acres each, than to any one Beau-Grazier whatever? From the twenty Tenures, the Landlord may, in any national Shock, raise a considerable Number of effective Hands, and zealous Hearts, for the Service of the Crown, or Defence of his Country; and reap many signal Advantages to the public and private Concernments of Life, not possibly derivable from the anti-social Monopolizers and Forestallers of Farms; who ever fondly attribute their Growth to their own Sagacity and Cleverness, without any the least Gratitude or Obligation to the Land-owner. These Sentiments, it is hoped, will every Day gain more and more Consideration with our wise and beneficent Legislature, Nobility and Gentry.

Many intelligent Persons, of all Ranks, complain much of the Want of some Establishment in the Way of a national Bank, to secure popular Credit, and the Kingdom from the various alarming Shocks it is so frequently incident to, on Account of the Failure of particular Banks.

The Nobility and Gentry of *Ireland*, are Loyalists and Patriots by Principle and Education: They are brave, without Arrogance; gay, without Levity; polite, without Affectation; charitable, without Ostentation; religious, without Formality; affable, without Meanness; generous, without View; and hospitable, without Reserve: In their Converse, easy; in their Dealings just; placable in their Resentments, in [pg 067] their Friendship steady:—They have neither the volatile Airyness of the *Frenchman*, the stated Gravity of the *Spaniard*; the suspicious Jealousy of the *Italian*; the forbidding Haughtiness of the *German*; the saturnine Gloominess of the *Flandrican*, nor the sordid Parsimony of the *Dutchman*: In short, they are neither whimsical, splenetic, sullen or capricious:—And, as for Cunning, Craft, or Dissimulation, these are such sorry Guests as never found Shelter in the

generous Breast of an *Irish* Noble or Gentleman; so that, if we consider this Country, with regard to its military Fame, constitutional Wisdom, Learning, Arts, Improvements, and natural Advantages; and above all, the benevolent Temper, charitable and hospitable Disposition of its Inhabitants; it is true, we may find many of more popular Bustle and Eclat, more extensive Commerce, greater Opulence and Pomp; but none of more general, solid, and intrinsick Worth, than *Ireland*.

I shall conclude with the following Proposition to any one, who may arrogate to himself Praise or Wit, by ridiculing *Ireland*.

*Si quid Novisti rectius istis—
Candidus imperti; Si non, his utere mecum.*

[pg 068]

The Farmer's Case Of The Roman-Catholics Of *Ireland*.

In a LETTER from a MEMBER of the PROTESTANT CHURCH.

DEAR SIR,

I think myself indebted to any Occasion that restores you to a Friend, whom I feared you had long forgotten. But I confess, at the same Time, that the Pleasure of hearing from you, after a Silence of Several Years, is, in some Measure, damped by the Censure that seems to constitute the chief Intent of your Letter.

[pg 069]

You tell me that you lately happened upon some Papers that were entitled The FARMER's LETTERS, &c. which were imputed to me as the Author. And, after some Compliments on Spirit, and Genius, and so forth, in order to palliate, as I suppose, what you purpose to administer, you charge me, by Implication, with Crimes, whose smallest Tendency I should abhor in myself, as in any Man breathing.

You say, favourably enough for your own Disposition, that you have long looked on the *Roman-Catholics* of these Kingdoms as a discountenanced and pitiable People. That you would choose to allow to others the same Latitude of Conscience that you like for yourself. That it is not a Part of Humanity to break a Reed already bruised. That such a Treatment would be blameable respecting any Individual; how much more so, in Prejudice of a whole People. That those Papers are pointed with a Keeness of Enmity, for which the Talents, which you are pleased to ascribe, cannot sufficiently apologize. And, that you did not think me capable of exasperating Government and Power against a Set of Men who were already under the Displeasure and Depression of the Law.

These, my dear Friend, are home and heavy Accusations, however tempered by Expressions of Kindness and Affection from the Man whom I sincerely love and respect.

But, if I know any-thing of myself, the Quality, called Ill-nature, is not my Characteristic. I would not exchange one Grain of Good-heart for all the Wit of a *C---d* or Comprehension of a *P--tt*, independent of their Virtue. And I may say, with great Truth, that an Excess [pg 070] of Humanity hath occasioned all the Misfortunes and Distresses of my Life.

I most solemnly assure you, that when I wrote those Letters I was in perfect Love and Charity with every *Roman Catholic* in the Kingdom of *Ireland*. I

knew that they were a depressed People. I had long pitied them as such. I was sensible that the Laws, under which they suffered, had been enacted by our Ancestors, when the Impressions of Hostility were fresh and warm, and when Passion, if I may venture to say so, co-operated, in some Measure, with Utility and Reason. I will go a Step further. I thought those Laws not severe enough to suppress them as Enemies, nor yet sufficiently favourable to attach them to us as Friends. They were not so cruel as, wholly, to serve for quelling; and yet they had a Poignancy that might tend to provoke. And all this I imputed to the Resentment that was blended with the Humanity of our Ancestors. Their Humanity left to Papists a Power of hurting, while their Resentment abridged the Inducements that might engage them to serve us.

Believe me, Sir, I never was of a cruel or persecuting Disposition. I was grieved to see the Discouragements under which the *Roman Catholics* of this Kingdom laboured, but these very Discouragements made me fear them the more.

Previous to the Letters, which you censure so warmly, a dangerous Rebellion had broken out in *Scotland*, in consequence of a *French* Invasion, that was headed by a Popish Pretender to the Throne. Be pleased to remember, (if it is not too mortifying a Recollection for a free-born *Briton*) the Pannic into which all *England* was [pg 071] struck by a few *Scotch* Vassals, undisciplined, and unactuated by any Motive of Liberty or Virtue, save the Virtue of being attached to their *Laird* or their *Leader*. Millions of *English*, at that Time, sunk in the Down of a long Peace, and enervated by ministerial Corruption and Venality, feared that a Handful of *Highlanders* would win their Way to *London*, and, at one Stroke, put a Period to the boasted Strength and Grandeur of the *British* Constitution.

I was astonished at the Apprehensions that *England* was under from so contemptible an Armament. But I deemed the Case of *Ireland* to be highly alarming. The *Roman-Catholics*, at that Time, outnumbered us Five to One. They were disarmed, it is true, but I was not equally sure that they had Reason to be reconciled. As they were not admitted to realize their Fortune, it consisted of ready Money, and that gave ready Power. As they were not permitted to purchase, or accept a Tenure of any valuable Length, Loyalty,

perhaps, might induce them to fight for their King; but where was the Stake to impel them to fight for a Country in which they had no *Inheritance*? Without an Interest in Lands, they had little to lose by any Change of Estate. Without a Loan lodged with Government, they had the less to lose by a Change of Constitution.

I cannot conceive how *Religion*, or mere Difference of Opinion, should prove a real Cause of Quarrel among Men; though it often serves as a *Word of War*, or a *Term* whereby to give Notice for Onset. On the contrary, I had observed that wherever People are united by *Interest*, though of a thousand opposite Sects, Persuasions [pg 072] and Professions, they never fail to join in the Maintenance and Defence of *common Rights*.

I, therefore, did not fear the *Roman Catholics*, as having a different *Religion*, but as having an *Interest* that was different from the Interest of *Protestants*. Were they a Compound of all the Follies, Absurdities, and Contradictions that ever were generated by Monster-bearing Superstition, had their Interest bound them to us, I should not have feared their *Fealty*.

But this was not the Case. The *French* Invasion of *Great Britain* was headed by a Person who was, by Birth, Education, Principle, and Interest, an Enemy to the Freedom and Rights of a Constitution that was established on the Dispossession of his Ancestors; and he was, consequently, an Enemy to the general Change of Privilege and Property, that ensued on the said Establishment. The said Change, as we all know, was to the Disadvantage of *Roman Catholics*. Had the Invader prevailed, a Change would again have ensued, in their Favour. Men naturally with Success to an Event from whence they propose Benefit; and it is as natural for them to act conformable to those Wishes.

Had *Roman Catholics* been possessed of an unrestrained Property, along with the other Liberties, Blessings, and Enjoyments, which they derived, in common with us, from the Establishment at the Revolution, no spiritual or temporal Power on Earth could have tempted them to permit, much less to wish, a Change of a Constitution whose Equal they could not find upon Earth.

But as this was very far from being the Fact, I feared that *Interest* might prove an Incentive [pg 073] to *Desire*; and *Desire* equally prove an Incentive to *Action*; and, I am not ashamed to confess, that my Expectations were greatly, though happily, disappointed, by the Steadiness of their peaceful and loyal Demeanour on that trying Occasion.

Believe me, my Friend, at the Time that I wrote those Papers, which have given you so much Offence, I looked upon the *Papists* of this Kingdom, by the Patronage of *France* and *Spain*, by their Numbers, by their Wealth, and by their Union with each other, to be vastly superior to *Irish Protestants*, in Power; and my Spirit of Opposition rose, in Proportion to my Idea of their Ability. But neither then, before, nor since, did I ever mean to excite any Action, or Intention, against the Weak, or the Oppressed, the Fallen, or the Afflicted.

When *Brutus* unsheathed the reluctant Sword of Freedom against his Friend, Humanity must suppose that his Heart was wrung with Compunction, while his Country enjoined and impelled the Blow.

But further, Sir, there is a very wide Difference between a *Popish Regency* and a *Popish People*. The whole Intent and Virulence, as you call it, of my Papers, is pointed and levelled against the *One*, but not a Syllable uttered, from End to End, against the *Other*. A *Popish Regency*, in Temporals alike as in Spirituals, I held to be, by Principle, an arbitrary and oppressive Government; but I held a *Popish People* to be, of all People, the most amenable and submissive to Rulers, whatever the Form or Nature of that State may be, under which they shall happen to be subjected. And, on this very Account, I dreaded them the more, should [pg 074] they become passive Instruments in the Hand of a Papal Dictator.

To apply a sure Test to the Propriety, or Impropriety, of my Apprehensions, at the Period when I wrote the *Farmer's Letters*, let us suppose that no one of the Penal Laws, which were instituted during the Reign of her Majesty Queen *Anne*, had yet passed into Form, but that Matters had remained in the same Situation, in which the *Monarch*, of *humane*, as well as *glorious Memory*, had left this unhappy People. Well, what would have been the Consequence? Would *Papists*, in that Case, have been less amenable to the Government, by which they had been favoured, supported, and cherished?

Would they have been the forwarder to bring Damage and Destruction on a Country, because their own Interest was connected therewith, and the Fortunes of their Posterity deposited therein? Would they have been the readier to attempt the Overthrow of our beneficent Constitution, because they enjoyed the Privileges and Advantages thereof? No, Sir, no. The Absurdity of the Supposition is inclusive of the Answer. Had this been the Case, the *Farmer's Letters* would not have existed to have caused the Renewal of our Acquaintance.

I have read and noted many Instances, in free States and Commonwealths, where *Liberty*, when fermented into *Licentiousness*, hath occasioned many partial Struggles for Power, many Broils and Factions, and much Disturbance to the Community. But very few are the Instances of the Insurrection of any People, who have not been goaded thereto by Severity and Oppression. The inoffensive Stag grows formidable when *at Bay*. The Worm turneth not, till it receiveth a Crush. [pg 075]

I forget the Book, though I remember the Passage, where a Prince demanded of his favourite Minister, what he should do with a Number of the Commons and Nobility, whom he had suppressed and taken Captive in the Act of Rebellion? The Minister answered, *Put them, and their Adherents, instantly to Death*. No, replied the Prince, that were an Act of such Bloodshed and Barbarity, as neither Fear nor Revenge shall persuade me to perpetrate. *Then, grant them all free Pardon*, rejoined the Minister. How! said the Prince, must Rebellion go altogether unpunished? There is no Medium that can assure your Safety, answered the Minister; you must either pull this Party wholly up by the Root, so as to leave no Fibre from whence future Enmity may grow; or else, you must change that Enmity into Friendship, by binding their Gratitude to your Person and Interest, with the kindest of all Connections, that of your Goodness and Favour. *A partial Punishment will be too little for your Safety; a partial Pardon will not be enough*. You must either wholly annihilate their Power, by their *Death*; or derive Strength to yourself, from that Power, by their *Friendship*.

By disarming our Enemies, the utmost we can hope, is, to render them impotent. The Diminution of *their* Power adds nothing to our *own*. Repentance is never so permanent or sincere, as when preceded by Pardon;

and Favour is, as the polar Attraction, to Inclination. Is there a Man whose Love and Gratitude you desire to engage? Common Sense will direct you to do him a Benefit. Would you bind him [pg 076] to your Service with Hoops of Steel? You must make it his Interest, as well as his Duty, to befriend you.

It is, by no means, my Intention to arraign either the Wisdom or good Policy of our Forefathers. But all Men are, in some Degree, fallible, as well in the congregate, as in the individual; and the Shrewd may err as much, by over-reaching their Aim, as the Ignorant, by falling short, or deviating from it.

But, had a hundred *Pitts*, and a hundred *Cecils*, composed the Senate of our Ancestors, at the Time that those *Penal Laws* were enacted; had those Laws been ever so wise and so just, so wholesome and necessary, and well suited to the Season; is that a Reason that they should *continue* so to the End of Time? In a World where nothing is permanent; where Modes, Manners, Principles, and Practice are at a Flux; where Life is uncertain, and all it contains changeable; Nature and Reason will conform to Situation and Circumstance; and where *Causes* have ceased, in any Degree, the *Consequences* ought to cease in the same Proportion.

It is not now with *Rome* as it was in the Days when Princes held her Steed, and Emperors her Stirrup. The Kings of the Earth have, pretty clearly, resumed her Usurpations and Acquisitions of temporal Dominion. It is not now, as it was when she cried Peace! and it became Peace; or when the Breath of her Mandate kindled the Nations to Battle. Even his *Holiness* is, now, but a poor limited Prince, pent up within his little *Italian Demesne*. If some few still acknowledge to hold of his Authority, it is a Homage of Words, and not of Facts; they will not acknowledge to hold of his Power. [pg 077] He is restored to the quiet and unenvied Possession of all the Lordship and Interest he can acquire in Heaven. But the Sceptre, even of his spiritual Dominion upon Earth, is, of late, as I take it, most wonderfully shortened.

Matters are much altered with the ecclesiastical World, even since I wrote the Letters that have roused your Spleen. Whether it be through a Decline of the *Romish* Religion, in particular; or, possibly, through a Decline of all Religion, in general; the pontifical and episcopal Dictatorship and Authority

are wofully fallen, from the Chair of Infallibility, where they had been seated by Opinion. The Sons of the most bigotted Ancestors do now perceive, that Piety and Immorality are not rightly consistent. And even the vulgar and ignorant, among the *Roman* Laity, would grumble at departing from an Inch of their Property, though the Priest should advise, and the Pope, himself, should enjoin it.

But, Sir, if the Change of Times, and Principles, Situation, and Circumstances; if the Change of every Cause that produced those penal Laws, have not availed for a Change of *Consequences*; for some Mitigation or Abatement of their Rigour, toward these my unhappy Brethren, the *Roman Catholics of Ireland*: If no Argument, I say, that is taken from Changes, may avail for the Purpose, I will take one from Permanence and Duration itself, that shall strike Light and Conviction to the Eye of every Beholder; that Power may *gainsay*, but cannot *refute*; that Malevolence may *dispute*, but never can *answer*.

About six Generations have now passed away, according to the Rates of Purchase and Estimate [pg 078] of the Life of Man, since these People have offended in Word or in Deed. No Riotings have been heard in their Houses, no Complaining in their Streets; they have been silent and harmless as Sheep before their Sheerers. Our Parties, Factions, and Insurrections, as they are merrily stiled in *England*, have been all among ourselves; this People were neither Actors nor Partakers therein. They have offered themselves to our Fleets, and to our Armies; to tend our Persons, to till our Grounds, to hew our Wood, and to draw our Water. Where we admit them to fight for us, they have ever proved valiant; where we admit them to serve us, they are found loving, observant, and faithful. Temptations have come to their Doors and called them forth; the Contagion of Rebellion hath broken out among their Neighbours; they have yet remained quiet, and continued untainted; still loyal to their Sovereign, amenable to Government, and submissive to Law, through a long and trying Succession of about seventy Years, they have scarce appeared to repine in the midst of their Calamities.

When I look back on the querulous and restless Nature of Man: When I trace the human Propensities through the Records of Ages and Nations: In all the Histories of those States who had least Cause of Complaint:

Throughout the Commonwealths of *Asia Minor*, the *Archipelago*, the *Grecian Continent*, *Italy*, the Islands of the *Mediterranean*, &c. where the RIGHTS OF NATURE, under Forms of various Institution, were ASSERTED BY LIBERTY AND GUARDED BY LAW: Where the ASSURANCE OF PROPERTY gave most REASON FOR CONTENT: I can find but few [pg 079] Instances of any People who, through such a Length of Time, have continued firm and unshaken, in an uninterrupted Loyalty and Submission to Government.

What then, do we look for further? What Proofs do ye yet require, of Peacefulness and Attachment at the Hands of these our Brethren? Is no Period to be put to their State of Probation? Must they *for ever* keep out upon *Quarantine*, without Harbour or Hopes of Rest or Reconciliation? That were hard, indeed.

If it is Revenge that we seek, they have, already, suffered enough, not for their own Faults, but for the Hostility of their Forefathers. If we seek our Safety, alone; let us chace *them, at once, from Country and Community*; or put an *End to our domestic Fears*, by giving them Cause to defend us.

Indeed, Sir, neither common Sense, nor Sense of any Kind, can possibly suppose, That Acts of Kindness which have been, from the Beginning of the World, the Cement of Friendship to all other People, should prove the reverse to these People alone.

Had they been to us, as the Swallow, in Autumn, who forsakes all Connections on the Approach of Inclemency, I should never have pleaded for any Confidence in them. But a People, who, through a Winter of seventy Years Continuance, have never failed, or forsaken, or given us Cause of Offence, surely merit some Consideration, some grateful and chearing Ray to warm them to a Sense that *Protestants* are not, by Choice, of a cruel, unforgiving, and malevolent Nature.

[pg 080]

Lastly, Sir, as I know you to be a Gentleman of a communicative Disposition, and that you were, formerly, fond of exhibiting the Sentiments of some of your Friends; should you impart this Letter to any of your popish Acquaintance, I doubt they might be apt to give me more Thanks

than I am conscious I deserve. It is, therefore, but commonly honest, to advertise you, and them, that while I write in the Favour of *Papists*, the Interest of *Protestants* is never out of my Eye.

When I thought your Favourites most formidable, I shewed I did not fear them; and now, that I think them impotent, let them not think I flatter.

What I have hitherto hinted is but a narrow opening to the Concerns and Interests of an unhappy Country, whereof I have the Misfortune to be a helpless, though loving, Member. To promote the Advantage of *Ireland*, in any respect, would be, to me, the cardinal Point of the whole Compass of my Ambition; and a subsequent Letter may shew how far my Observations relate to the Decline, or Prosperity, of my Country, whenever you confer the Pleasure of an Answer on,

Dear SIR,
Your truly affectionate, &c.

Footnotes

- [1.](#) *Dublin, 1753, M. Reilly, Editor.*
- [2.](#) This *Mac Con More Macnamara*, Duke of *Klan Cullane*, founded, erected, and amply endowed the beautiful Abbey of *Quin*; as did other Chieftains of his Name and Family, several Parochial Churches, with a great Number of magnificent Castles.

3. *Seasonable Thoughts, &c.* published by *George Faulkner*; *the Case of the Roman Catholics*, and *the Principles of the Roman Catholics*, the two last published by *P. Lord*, in *Cook-street, Dublin*.
 4. To all the above Productions of *Ireland*, may be justly added, our inestimable Fisheries, and plentiful Mines, which, under due national Encouragement, would raise immense Treasures.
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*** END OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK AN ESSAY ON
THE ANTIENT AND MODERN STATE OF IRELAND ***

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